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The volatile and often falling market phase since September 2024 has now lasted 18 months. It has taken a toll on most investors, whether they deal in stocks directly or take exposure through mid- and small-cap funds. However, the equity schemes of the National Pension System (NPS) have done quite well relatively having contained downsides better than standard benchmarks and comparable mutual fund category.

The performance of other asset classes of NPS was also fairly robust. Corporate bond and government schemes delivered steady positive returns.

Here is an account of the performance of NPS equity, corporate bond and G-Sec schemes from September 2024 till March 2026 and the key takeaways for investors. We have considered all the 10 NPS players offering tier-1 schemes. These include pension funds from Aditya Birla, Axis, HDFC, Kotak, ICICI, LIC, UTI, DSP, Tata and SBI.

MANOEUVRING SMARTLY

In the 18-month period mentioned earlier, the NPS equity schemes have fallen 9.3 per cent. This is better than the Nifty 100 TRI, which fell 11 per cent, or the Nifty 50 TRI that corrected 9.7 per cent. NPS equity schemes have also done better than large-cap mutual funds as the latter fell 9.7 per cent in the past 1.5 years.

In general, NPS equity schemes stick to the top 100 stocks by market capitalisation even though they are allowed to go up to the top 200 stocks. This investment pattern helps restrict downsides during broader market falls.

Corporate bond schemes of NPS have done reasonably well, delivering 10.2 per cent in this period on an average as a category. The CRISIL Composite Index gave 8.1 per cent in the same timeframe.

Mutual funds investing in corporate bonds also gave 10.2 per cent. Medium-duration funds, though, have done better, delivering 11.3 per cent. All the NPS corporate bond schemes invest almost entirely in AA-rated corporate bonds spanning private and public sector companies. Typically, the average maturity of these portfolios would range from



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Steady show in a correcting market

PENSION-WISE. Here's how NPS equity funds, corporate bond schemes and G-Sec offerings performed from September 2024 to March 2026

How NPS funds fared from 2024 market highs

Funds and indices	Return (%)
NPS Equity schemes	-9.3
Nifty 100 TRI	-11
Nifty 50 TRI	-9.7
Large Cap mutual funds	-9.7
NPS Corporate bond schemes	10.2
CRISIL Composite Bond Index	8.1
Corporate bond mutual funds	10.2
Medium duration mutual funds	11.3
NPS Government bond schemes	4.2
CRISIL 10-year Gilt Index	7.3
Gilt funds with 10-year duration	8.2
Long duration mutual funds	2.7

Source: ACE MF, NPS Trust; Absolute returns of indices and fund category averages from Sep 26, 2024 to March 25, 2026

four-six years. The modified duration is typically four-five years.

Given that much of the rally in the longer end of the yield curve had already taken place in 2023-24 and early 2025, in anticipation of interest rate cuts, there was underperformance subsequently over the past year or so.

Therefore, NPS government bonds schemes that invest in se-

curities maturing 10-50 years into the future gave moderate returns at 4.2 per cent, which was still better than long-duration mutual funds that delivered only 2.7 per cent in the past 18 months.

ALLOCATION MATTERS

Though the relative performance of NPS equity schemes has been reasonable, the quantum of fall

NPS EDGE

- NPS equity fell less than key benchmarks
- Corporate bond schemes delivered steady double-digit category returns
- Government bond schemes beat long-duration MFs

and the larger pointers to portfolio stability need to be addressed.

For a few categories of NPS investors, the negative returns in equities over a prolonged period emphasise the need for reasonable allocation to bonds. Constant rebalancing is important to safeguard portfolio returns.

For those NPS investors who are looking solely at NPS proceeds for their retirement income, going low on risks with modest allocation to equities and sizeable exposure to corporate and government schemes may be necessary. A 10-15 per cent cut as seen in the recent past in an equity-heavy

NPS portfolio can seriously dent your overall corpus size.

For those with higher equity allocations (60 per cent or higher), paring NPS equity exposure every year in their 50s and bringing it down substantially closer to retirement at the age 60 may help.

In case you are not able to decide a suitable allocation pattern, there are some options given by NPS fund managers themselves. The lifecycle 75 (starts at 75 per cent equity at age 35 and reduces gradually to 15 per cent after age 55), lifecycle 50 (starts at 50 per cent and reduces to 10 per cent), or lifecycle 25 (starts at 25 per cent and reduces to 5 per cent) can be taken, depending on your risk appetite and criticality of NPS to your steady retirement income.

Even for those primarily investing in mutual funds, with exposure being taken to NPS an additional avenue, it would make sense to take moderate risks (debt-heavy asset mix), so that a corrective phase closer to retirement still ensures a steady NPS corpus at least till such time as equity mutual funds recover.

Before you buy an ETF

PASSIVE PLAY. Focus on liquidity, premium and discount to NAV, tracking error and cost of the products

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau



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Over the past two years, exchange traded funds (ETFs) offering gold and silver have attracted significant attention from retail investors, emerging as a convenient route to gain exposure to precious metals. At the same time, ETFs that track major equity indices have also found a place in individual portfolios as passive investing gathers pace in India. This shift is reflected in the sharp rise in passive mutual fund assets, which have grown more than fivefold from about ₹2.8 lakh crore in February 2021 to nearly ₹15 lakh crore by February 2026. The number of investor folios has also surged, reaching around 3.4 crore during the same period.

With the ETF universe expanding to 314 funds tracking 118 different indices, selecting the right ETF has become increasingly important, particularly for small investors. Here are key factors to keep in mind when choosing ETFs for your portfolio.

LIQUIDITY

Unlike regular mutual funds, ETF units are bought and sold on the stock exchange. This means that when you place an order, there must be enough market participants willing to take the other side of the trade. If trading activity is thin, you may struggle to buy or sell units at a reasonable price.

For investors who trade ETFs through the exchange, the practical approach is to stick to funds that show consistent trading activity. ETFs that record transactions almost every day and maintain reasonable turnover tend to provide better price discovery and smoother execution.

Interestingly, the Nippon India Silver ETF has become one of the top traded securities on domestic exchanges. For instance, over the last three months, between

December 27, 2025 and March 27, 2026, the average daily traded volume on the NSE in the Nippon India Silver ETF was ₹2,986 crore. This is higher than the trading volumes of top equity stocks such as Infosys and Reliance Industries, which saw average traded volumes of ₹1,638 crore and ₹2,064 crore respectively during the period. Other actively traded commodity ETFs include Nippon India ETF Gold BeES (average daily volume of ₹1,174 crore), Tata Silver ETF (₹796 crore) and ICICI Prudential Silver ETF (₹503 crore). On the equity side, the top traded ETFs include Nippon India ETF Nifty 50 BeES (₹280 crore), Nippon India ETF Nifty IT (₹77 crore) and Motilal Oswal Nifty India Defence ETF (₹44 crore).

IMPACT COST

Trading activity also affects another important metric known as impact cost. This refers to the hidden transaction cost that arises from the bid-ask spread in the market. When liquidity is limited, the gap between the price at which buyers are willing to purchase and sellers are willing to sell

● MANY CHOICES

The ETF universe has expanded to 314 funds tracking 118 different indices

tends to widen. As a result, investors may end up paying more than expected while buying, or receiving less than expected while selling.

Stock exchanges publish impact cost statistics for various securities. For instance, the mean impact cost for HDFC Bank and Infosys on the NSE as of March 2026 was 0.01 per cent and 0.02 per cent respectively. Among ETFs, the Nippon India Nifty 50 ETF had an impact cost of 0.02 per cent and the Nippon India Nifty Mid-cap 150 ETF had 0.03 per cent. Among commodity ETFs, Nippon India's Gold and Silver ETFs recorded impact costs of 0.02 per cent and 0.06 per cent respectively. ETFs with impact costs around 0.10 per cent are typically considered more efficient to trade.

PREMIUM & DISCOUNT

Another feature unique to ETFs is that their market price can deviate from their

intrinsic value during trading hours. Since ETF units trade on the exchange, their price may sometimes move above or below the indicative net asset value (iNAV). These deviations occur mainly when liquidity is limited or when market makers are not actively arbitraging the price difference.

The iNAV reflects the real-time value of the ETF's underlying portfolio and is calculated by the exchange based on the market prices of the constituent securities. If the ETF's market price is higher than the iNAV, it is said to trade at a premium; if it is lower, it trades at a discount. Persistent premiums or discounts can increase the effective cost of investing. Therefore, ETFs whose market prices tend to stay close to their iNAV are generally preferable.

Recent instances in overseas ETFs illustrate the extent of the issue. As of March 27, 2026, six overseas ETFs, including Mirae Asset NYSE FANG+ ETF, Mirae Asset S&P 500 Top 50 ETF and Nippon India ETF Hang Seng BeES, were trading at premiums of 6-25 per cent to their closing NAV due to the absence of market mak-

ing and higher investor interest.

TRACKING ERROR

Apart from these trading-related factors, investors should also examine how closely an ETF replicates its benchmark index. This is measured through tracking error, which captures the variation in the difference between the returns of the ETF and those of the index it seeks to follow. Ideally, this gap should be minimal. Tracking difference, another measure, simply shows the difference between the returns of the ETF and the index. These differences can arise due to factors such as expense ratio, cash holdings within the fund or delays in rebalancing the portfolio when the index composition changes.

ETFs with lower tracking error (calculated daily using the last three years' data) include Mirae Asset Nifty Financial Services ETF (0.02 per cent), DSP Nifty Bank ETF (0.02 per cent), Nippon India ETF Nifty Bank BeES (0.02 per cent) and SBI Nifty 50 ETF (0.03 per cent).

TOTAL EXPENSE RATIO

Cost is another advantage that ETFs offer. Because they are passively managed, their expense ratios are far lower than those charged by actively managed equity funds. For example, ETFs that track the Nifty 50 charge an average expense ratio of around 0.1 per cent as of February 2026. In comparison, actively managed large-cap equity funds charge around 2 per cent under regular plans and about 0.9 per cent under direct plans.

Even index funds tend to cost more, with expense ratios around 0.5 per cent for regular plans and 0.2 per cent for direct plans. A higher expense ratio in ETFs can add up over time and increase the total cost ownership, which may affect returns in the long run.

ALERTS.

PNB launches Digi MSME Prime

Punjab National Bank (PNB) has launched Digi MSME Prime, an enhanced digital lending solution, aimed at expanding fast and seamless credit access for Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs). The initiative is built on a Straight Through Processing model that minimises manual intervention and enables quicker loan approvals and disbursements. Under this platform, MSMEs can avail loans of up to ₹10 crore, with eligibility primarily assessed through GST turnover and business cash flows, reducing the need for extensive documentation.

Cardless cash withdrawals via UPI QR

RNFI Services, through its fintech platform Relipay, has made a nationwide rollout of its UPI QR-based cash withdrawal service in partnership with Jio Payments Bank. The service enables customers to withdraw cash instantly by scanning a UPI QR code at authorised outlets in RNFI's BC network. Customers can simply scan the QR code, enter the withdrawal amount and authenticate using their UPI PIN. Once completed, the merchant dispenses the cash, enabling a frictionless assisted transaction experience. The service offers a per transaction limit of ₹5,000, with a daily limit of ₹10,000 and a monthly limit of ₹50,000.

Interest rates on home loans (%)

Institution	Loan amount		
	Under ₹30 lakh	₹30 to 75 lakh	Over ₹75 lakh
BANKS (Floating rates)			
Axis Bank	7.75-8.55	7.75-8.55	7.75-8.55
Bank of Baroda	7.0-8.35	7.0-8.35	7.0-8.35
Bank of India	6.85-7.75	6.85-7.75	6.85-7.75
Bank of Maharashtra	7.05≥	7.05≥	7.05≥
Canara Bank	6.9-8.9	6.9-8.9	6.9-8.9
Central Bank	6.85-7.3	6.85-7.3	6.85-7.3
DBS Bank	7.2	7.2	7.2
Federal Bank	7.90- 7.95	7.90- 8.0	7.95-8.05
HDFC Bank	6.95-7.5	6.95-7.75	6.95-7.85
ICICI Bank	6.90-7.85	6.90-7.95	7.00- 8.05
Indian Bank	7.15-7.25	7.15-7.35	7.25-7.5
Indian Overseas Bank	7.05	7.05-7.15	7.15-7.3
IDBI Bank	7.4-8.4	7.4-8.4	7.4-8.4
J&K Bank	7.2-7.3	7.2-7.3	7.2-7.6
Karnataka Bank	8.17-8.99	8.17-8.99	8.17-8.99
Karur Vysya Bank	7.45-9.55	7.45-9.55	7.45-9.55
Kotak Mahindra Bank	7.10-9.20	7.10-9.20	7.10-9.30
Punjab National Bank	7.10-7.5	7.10-7.65	7.25-7.75
Punjab & Sind Bank	6.9-7.25	6.9-7.25	6.9-7.25
State Bank of India	6.95-7.35	6.95-7.5	7.2-7.6
South Indian Bank	7.9-9.40	7.9-9.40	7.9-9.55
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	8.45	8.45	8.45
UCO Bank	7.15-7.25	7.15-7.25	7.15-7.25
Union Bank of India	6.7-7.1	6.7-7.1	6.95-7.15

BANKS (Fixed rates)			
Axis Bank	12	12	12
HDFC Bank	7.4-7.95	7.4-8.10	7.55- 8.20
IDBI bank	9.85-10.10	9.85-10.10	9.85-10.10
Union Bank of India	11.4	11.4-12.4	12.4-12.65

HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Floating rates)			
Tata Capital	8.5-8.75	8.5-8.75	8.5-8.75
Piramal Cap & Housing Fin	≥9.65	≥9.65	≥9.65
PNB Housing	7.9- 9.7	7.9- 9.7	7.9- 9.7
Central Bank Housing	10.10-11.3	10.10-11.8	10.10-11.8
HDFC	6.90-7.65	6.90-7.9	7.0-8.0
Indiabulls Housing Fin	≥8.99	≥8.99	≥8.99
Aditya Birla Housing Fin	9-12.5	9-12.5	9-12.5
Bajaj Finserv	≥7.5	≥7.5	≥7.5
GIC Housing Finance	9.1-12.5	9.1-12.5	9.1-12.5
Reliance Home Finance	9.75-13	9.75-13	9.75-13
Sundaram Home Finance	8.60-9.50	8.60-9.50	8.60-9.50

HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Fixed rates)			
HDFC	7.4-8.1	7.4-8.25	7.55-8.35

*Data as on respective banks' website on July 8, 2022; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; Interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com

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TATA mutual fund

NOTICE

Unitholders are hereby informed about the declaration of Income Distribution cum capital withdrawal under the Monthly Payout / Reinvestment of Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal option* of the following scheme. The record date for the same is 01 April, 2026.

Schemes - Plan / Option Name	Gross income distribution cum capital withdrawal amount per unit (Rs.) **	Face value per unit (₹)	NAV (₹) as on 25 Mar, 26
Tata Aggressive Hybrid Fund - Direct Plan*	0.79	10.00	95.7150
Tata Aggressive Hybrid Fund - Regular Plan*	0.79	10.00	79.9643

*(Monthly Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal is not assured & is subject to the availability of distributable surplus).

Pursuant to payment of Income Distribution cum capital withdrawal, the NAV of the scheme would fall to the extent of the payout & statutory levy (if applicable).

Unitholders kindly note that amounts are distributed out of investors capital (i.e., Equalisation Reserve), which is part of sale price of the unit that represents realized gains.

** Payment of Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal is subject to Tax deducted at source (TDS) at applicable rates and other statutory levies if any. Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal is subject to availability & adequacy of distributable surplus on the record date.

All unitholders holding units under the above-mentioned option of the scheme as at close of business hours, on the record date shall be eligible for dividend.

Considering the volatile nature of markets, the Trustees reserves the right to restrict the quantum of Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal upto the per unit distributable surplus available on the record date in case of fall in the market.

Applicable for units held in non-demat form: Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal will be paid to those Unitholders whose names appear in the Register of Unitholders under the Payout /Reinvestment of Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal option of the aforesaid plan as on record date. These payouts would be done to the last bank/address details updated in our records.

Applicable for units held in demat form: Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal will be paid to those Unitholders/Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories under the Payout/Reinvestment of Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal option of the aforesaid plan as on record date. These payouts would be done to the last bank/address details updated in Depository Participant(s) records.

Mutual Fund Investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

The US-Iran conflict has impacted every segment of the equity market in the last three weeks including the healthcare sector, BSE Healthcare and Nifty Pharma nonetheless.

Compared to 11 per cent decline year-to-date in Nifty 50, BSE Healthcare has declined by 2 per cent and Nifty Pharma has remained flat.

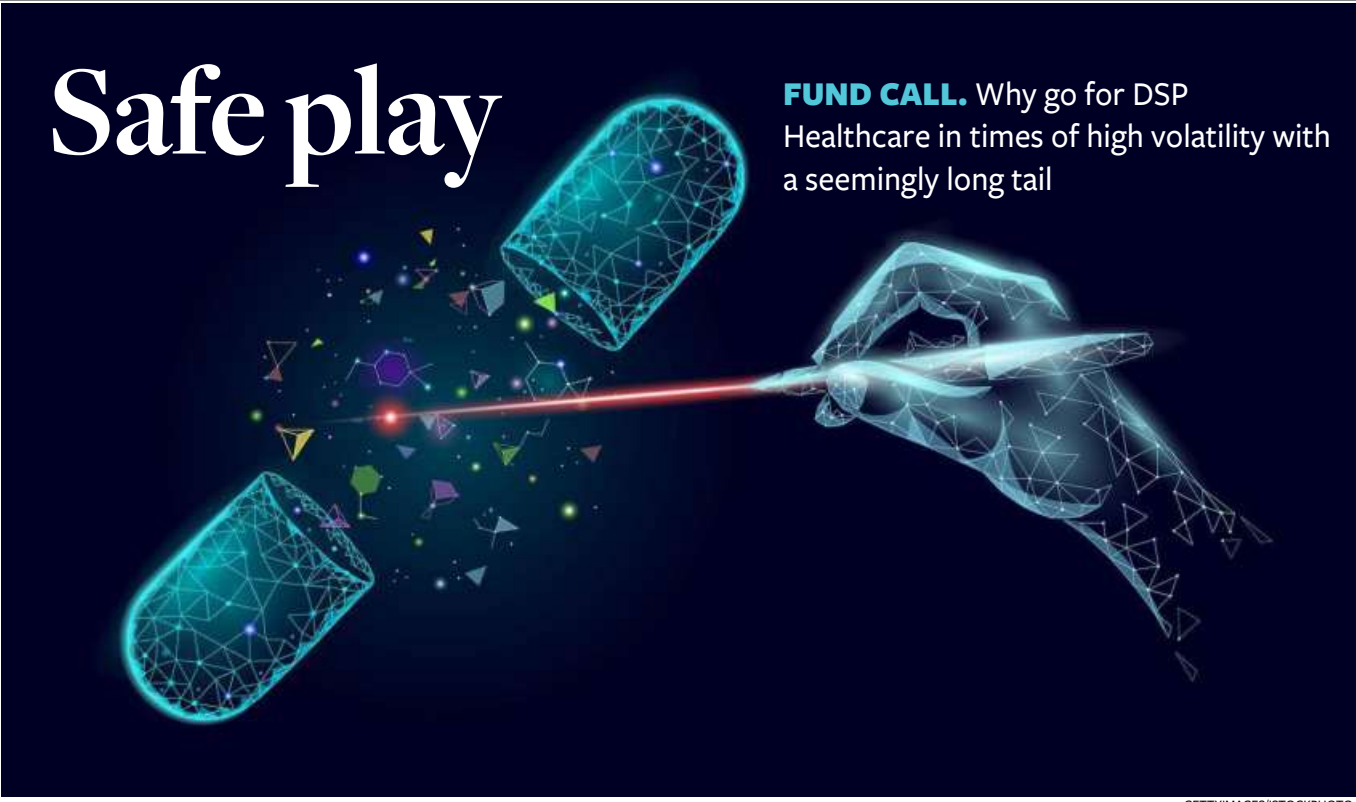
Despite the impact, sector exposure is necessary for downside protection in case of the conflict spreading and lasting for longer a timeline.

If countries manage to avoid a force majeure in the medium term, the sector also has an upside potential. Investors should gain exposure to the sector through SIPs in such volatile markets to hedge against uncertainties.

We reviewed healthcare funds in January 2026, and DSP Healthcare was noted as a top-performing fund in the sector. We now review the fund's performance and its latest portfolio holdings for investors to consider.

LONGER IMPACT

Equity market volatility in the last three weeks is a reaction to disrupted supplies in the short



term, but more importantly it is also a reflection of long-term impact post the conflict. A long-lasting impact on energy infrastructure will reshape earnings trajectory stemming from energy and commodity costs, logistics costs, export market potential and consump-

tion patterns domestically and internationally. The broader index decline is attributable to such factors.

The impact in pharma and diagnostic labs should be limited to cost of precursor chemicals from China.

While operational challenges on energy, logistics and power will be volatile, the cost impact should not be material and similar is the case for hospitals. Healthcare sector's downside should be limited compared to broader index, as has been the case so far.

UPSIDE POTENTIAL

Pharmaceuticals, which account for the largest share of the healthcare sector, are eyeing the next large opportunity with generic semaglutide launch in diabetes and weight management segments in India.

The fourth quarter results discussion in April-May should draw focus on the opportunity and each company's approach for the opportunity starting from key starting material production (Divi's or other CDMO players), or in partnership (Cipla with Eli Lilly for tirzepatide) or with their own generic (Sun Pharma, Torrent Pharma, Dr. Reddy and others).

The US market with stable generic pricing, and branded pharma growth in India and other emerging markets, are also positives for the sector.

Hospitals and diagnostics are continuing with their expansion plans.

The lack of pricing power for

WHY INVEST

- Outperforms benchmarks consistently
- Well diversified with 30 stocks
- Strong exposure to emerging CDMO companies

diagnostics is being substituted with volume growth and launch of packaged tests.

Hospitals have added robotic surgeries along with capacity expansions, allowing for a strong pricing and volume lever for the sector.

Valuations, in the initial phase of the conflict, are reflecting the long-term impact on the economy versus the upside potential of the sector.

BSE Healthcare and Nifty Pharma one-year forward PE are at a 8-10 per cent premium to last five-year average compared to a 10 per cent discount for Nifty 50.

PERFORMANCE

The fund has outperformed benchmarks consistently. Since its launch in November 2018, based on daily average of rolling returns, the fund has beaten BSE Healthcare - fairly (which is the composite of pharma and healthcare) and Nifty Pharma - significantly, as shown in the table for 1-year, 3-year and 5-year timeframes.

An SIP in the fund from inception would have yielded an

XIRR of 18.4 per cent compared to 13.5 per cent for Nifty Pharma and 14.9 per cent for Nifty-50 TRI indices.

The outperformance is also reflected in the percentage of days the fund beat the index outperforming Nifty Pharma 98 per cent of the days on a 5-year rolling return basis and BSE Healthcare only 72 per cent of the days, pointing to a consistent but modest outperformance against the composite index. Since August 2025, the BSE Healthcare 5-year rolling returns have bettered the fund's performance on most of the days.

The fund holdings are well diversified with 30 stocks in the portfolio as of February 2026. The top-5 stocks by weight (Sun Pharma, IPCA Labs, Cipla, Globus Medical and Laurus Labs) account for 40 per cent of the portfolio.

The fund has a 17 per cent exposure to international med-tech companies: Globus, Illumina, and Intuitive Surgicals.

The domestic diagnostics exposure is limited to Vijaya Diagnostics.

The fund has a strong exposure to emerging CDMO companies Laurus, Sai Lifesciences and Cohance. Hospitals exposure is led by Apollo Hospitals and Kovai Medical.

Pharmaceutical exposure with Sun, Cipla and IPCA Labs should provide generic semaglutide launch exposure as well with Sun Pharma being a leader in Indian pharma and diabetes segments.

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on March 27	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension	51	14	12	14	75,761
Kotak Pension	63	14	13	13	4,578
ICICI Pru Pension	68	15	13	13	27,525
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension	30	7	6	8	8,462
SBI Pension	40	7	6	8	27,593
HDFC Pension	28	6	5	8	50,186
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension	30	8	7	8	32,602
ICICI Pru Pension	45	8	7	8	12,907
SBI Pension	45	8	7	8	14,642
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension	44	14	12	14	1,836
ICICI Pru Pension	54	15	13	13	773
Kotak Pension	56	14	13	13	224

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on March 27, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	288	26.8	24.0	22.8
ICICI Pru	Largecap	882	24.9	23.7	20.2
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	21.4	21.9	17.3
Ksema Wealth	Alpha	16	24.4	19.5	16.4
MULTI CAP					
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	118	19.1	32.9	25.9
ICICI Pru	Largecap	1,077	31.1	30.1	25.6
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	118	23.9	32.4	24.9
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	10.2	22.3	24.8
Invasset	Growth Pro Max	359	11.3	36.7	24.6
Buoyant Capital	Opportunities	9,127	30.1	26.1	24.2
MID-CAP					
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	12.3	18.1	19.1
Master Portfolio Services	Master Trust India Growth	346	20.0	16.2	19.0
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	12.2	17.8	18.2
Sundaram Alternate Assets	SELF Portfolio	NA	35.8	22.6	17.3
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	4,457	61.8	51.5	46.6
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	793	-0.2	22.8	37.4
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,108	-5.3	31.2	25.1
Accuracap	Dynamo	13	13.3	29.7	23.6

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on February 28, 2026

Big size doesn't kill mutual fund performance

RETURN-WISE. Across large-cap, mid-cap, small-cap and flexi-cap categories, the biggest schemes performed well, suggesting that large AUM by itself is not necessarily a challenge

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
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Did you know just 27 mutual fund schemes, out of a universe of over 1,900, each manage more than ₹50,000 crore in assets? Together, these giant funds account for nearly ₹21 lakh crore, or about a quarter of the industry's total Assets Under Management (AUM) of ₹82 lakh crore as of February 2026. Of these 27, 11 are actively managed equity funds, including behemoths such as Parag Parikh Flexi Cap (₹1.34 lakh crore), HDFC Flexi Cap (₹1 lakh crore), and HDFC Mid Cap (₹94,257 crore), which incidentally are bigger than many listed firms.

As equity fund AUM swells, some schemes are becoming too large to ignore. That revives an old question: does size hurt performance? As funds grow, deploying money gets harder, agility falls, and returns can suffer, especially in mid- and small-cap segments where liquidity is thinner. But does the data support this perception? A bl.portfolio analysis

of the largest schemes across key active equity categories over the past five years suggests that size, by itself, is not a handicap.

WHAT WE STUDIED

The study aims to understand how large-sized funds perform compared with their peers in actively managed equity categories such as large-cap, mid-cap, small-cap, and flexi-cap. To do this, we selected the top three funds by assets as of February 2021 and tracked their performance over the following years against other funds in their categories. The analysis covers 27 large-cap funds, 24 mid-cap funds, 22 small-cap funds, and 24 flexi-cap funds. At the time of selection, the chosen funds had assets ranging from ₹7,311 crore to ₹34,515 crore, which were considered sizeable given the market depth then.

We then evaluated their performance relative to peers over the next five years, from March 2021 to March 2026, using rolling returns. Both one-year and three-year rolling returns were computed and ranked into quartiles,



from the top quartile (Q1) to the bottom quartile (Q4), to assess relative performance within each category. A quartile divides a group into four equal parts of 25 per cent each. For instance, SBI Large Cap Fund, based on 1,462 one-year rolling return observations, had about 50 per cent of instances in Q1, 19 per cent in Q2, 7 per cent in Q3, and 24 per cent in Q4.

RESULTS

First, the largest fund in each category delivered strong and consistent performance. ICICI Pru Large Cap Fund had 100 per cent of its three-year rolling returns in the top two quartiles (Q1 and Q2, which lie above the category average). Similarly, HDFC Mid Cap

MIND IT

Size usually becomes a problem only when market conditions turn and liquidity tightens

and Nippon India Small Cap recorded all their observations in the top two quartiles, while Kotak Flexicap had 87 per cent of its returns in these segments. This indicates that scale, in itself, has not hindered performance.

Second, when the analysis is expanded to include the top two and top three funds by assets, outcomes become more varied. While some funds consistently dominate top-quartile rankings,

others lag. For example, UTI Flexi Cap, Axis Large Cap, and DSP Midcap saw all their three-year returns fall in the lower quartiles (Q3 and Q4, which lie below the category average). In these cases, the chosen investment style may not have translated into favourable outcomes. Among the 12 largest funds studied, five consistently outperformed, four delivered mixed results, and three underperformed, based on both 1-year and 3-year rolling returns. Overall, performance among large sized funds across categories remains a mixed bag, with no clear evidence that higher AUM leads to weaker outcomes.

Third, several funds that were relatively small in 2021 have scaled up significantly while de-

living strong returns. Parag Parikh Flexi Cap Fund grew from ₹7,452 crore to ₹1.34 lakh crore, Nippon India Growth Mid Cap from ₹8,990 crore to ₹43,000 crore, Motilal Oswal Mid Cap from ₹1,902 crore to ₹33,689 crore, Bandhan Small Cap from ₹930 crore to ₹20,474 crore, and Quant Small Cap from ₹135 crore to ₹27,654 crore. This highlights how sustained performance can drive rapid asset growth.

GROWTH DRIVERS

Consistent outperformance remains the key trigger for inflows, as investors and distributors gravitate towards funds with strong track records.

Market cycles also play a role, with mid- and small-cap funds attracting higher inflows during bullish phases. Distribution strength further amplifies growth. Funds backed by large AMCs, with wide distributor networks and strong brand recall, tend to attract steady SIP flows. In addition, star fund managers, favourable ratings, and media visibility help channel incremental capital. At the core, flagship schemes are carefully and deliberately nurtured by fund houses through strong research, disciplined portfolio construction, and continuous monitoring. Examples include Parag Parikh Flexi Cap and Kotak Flexi Cap Fund. These schemes receive sustained attention from experienced investment teams, helping them build long-term track records and investor confidence, which in turn drives steady asset growth for the AMC.

SIZE EDGE

Large funds benefit from advantages that smaller peers may lack. Big AMCs also have deeper research capabilities and stronger engagement with company managements.

The impact of size, however, varies across market cap seg-

ments. In large-cap and flexi-cap funds, size is less of a constraint. In some cases, strategy plays a key role.

In mid- and small-cap funds, capacity constraints are more relevant. Deploying large inflows into relatively illiquid stocks can raise entry costs. In large funds, even a 1 per cent allocation can amount to ₹300 crore, making it difficult to build positions without influencing prices. Managers may respond by diversifying across more stocks or favouring relatively liquid names, which can moderate alpha. Large schemes such as Nippon India Small Cap Fund, for instance, maintain highly diversified portfolios (244 stocks as of February 2026). That said, experienced fund managers mitigate these challenges through staggered deployment, liquidity discipline, and robust portfolio construction. Hence, several large funds continue to deliver strong performance despite having scale.

TAKEAWAYS

Size alone is not a red flag. The biggest fund in each category generally held up well. But that pattern did not carry across all large funds, where results were far more mixed. In many cases, good performance seems to have created size, not the other way round.

Several funds scaled up sharply over the period while still delivering strong returns. What matters more than corpus, is what scale does to the strategy. That is more relevant in mid- and small-cap funds, where liquidity can shape portfolio choices.

Lastly, size usually becomes a problem only when market conditions turn and liquidity tightens. Until then, strong returns can mask rising capacity stress.

So, investors should judge not just returns, but whether a fund can stay true to its strategy as it gets bigger.

Engineered to tide through disrupting times

INFRASTRUCTURE. A solid order-book, traction across key segments and proven execution capabilities in complex engineering projects are positives for Larsen & Toubro (L&T)

Venkatasubramanian K
bl. research bureau

In an environment where the frontline indices are correcting sharply and stocks in many segments are being decimated, restoring a sense of stability in investors is quite challenging.

Although not fully immune, select large-cap companies offer some resilience amid heightened volatility and uncertainty with the war in West Asia as well as the energy supply chain bottlenecks that it has caused.

In this regard, engineering major and conglomerate Larsen & Toubro (L&T) with subsidiaries spanning IT, financial services and a few other key industries requires investor attention.

Although L&T has significant operations in West Asia, the company has recently said that 95 per cent of its sites are functioning normally and the war's impact has not been very significant as of now on order executions.

In a somewhat ironic twist, given L&T's extremely strong presence in the energy segment in West Asia and long association with top players, all the reconstruction of factories, refineries, airports and other infrastructure actually opens up future opportunities.

Nonetheless, some disruptions are possible in the current unpredictable scenario, though long-term visibility still remains healthy for the company.

After touching a peak of ₹4,440 in February this year, L&T's shares corrected sharply by almost 25 per cent, before recovering some ground over the past few days.

At ₹3,570, the stock of L&T trades at around 20 times its likely per share earnings for FY27, making it a reasonably-attractive bet for those with a horizon of three-plus years. Over the past three years, the stock has generally traded north of 27 times.

Investors wishing to play relatively cautiously in light of the war and other uncertainties can consider accumulating the stock at



current levels and adding more on declines linked to the broader market.

A solid order-book, traction across key segments of operations and proven execution capabilities in complex engineering projects (domestic and international) are all positives for the company. A well-established marquee client base domestically and internationally is a key advantage for L&T.

Over the three financial years from FY22, L&T's consolidated revenue grew at a CAGR of 17.8 per cent to ₹2,55,734 crore in FY25, while net profits (excluding exceptional items) grew at 19.3 per cent over the same period to ₹14,562 crore. Including the exceptional items – profits from discontinued operations – the net profit for FY25 would be a tad higher at ₹15,037 crore.

In the 9MFY26 period, the

company's revenue grew 12 per cent to ₹2,03,112 crore, while adjusted net profit increased 25 per cent over the same period to ₹11,949 crore.

If the one-time exceptional item of provisions made for the new social security wage code are included (₹1,190 crore), the net profit figure would be ₹10,758 crore (up 13 per cent).

ENGINEERING PROWESS

L&T's core business broadly fall under three segments – infrastructure, energy and hi-tech manufacturing projects.

Infrastructure projects include buildings & factories, heavy civil works, water treatment plants, transmission & distribution, renewables, transportation, and minerals & metals. This segment contributed 46 per cent of overall revenues for 9MFY26 and grew 4 per cent.

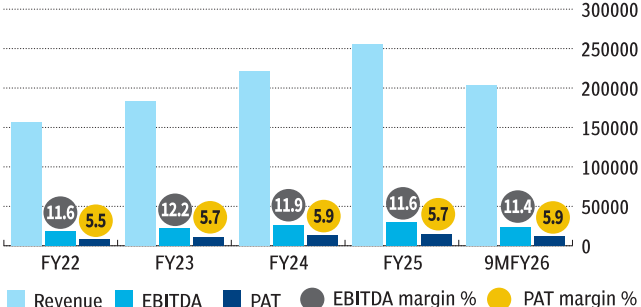
Energy projects include hydro-carbon, CarbonLite solutions and clean energy works. This vertical accounted for 19 per cent of revenues in 9MFY26, up a solid 35 per cent.

Hi-tech manufacturing includes heavy engineering, precision engineering & systems and electrolyser manufacturing. This sector made up 4 per cent of revenues and grew by a healthy 46 per cent.

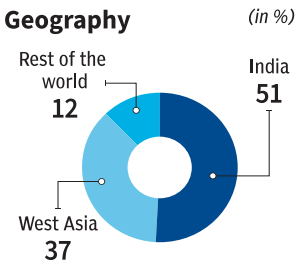
Then there are developmental projects such as the Hyderabad metro, Nabha Power and green energy. In addition, there are realty and construction projects that the company undertakes. These two segments together accounted for 3 per cent of overall revenues with realty witnessing robust traction.

At such a large scale, L&T steadily maintains a healthy overall consolidated EBITDA margin

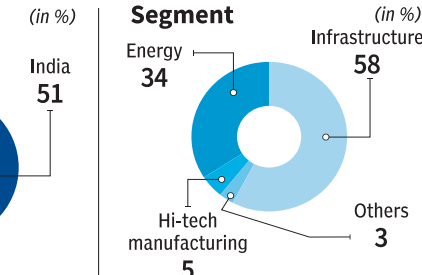
Healthy operational performance



Geography



Order-book mix



● ACCUMULATE

Larsen & Toubro
₹3,570

WHY

- Long revenue visibility with large order-book
- Strong execution record
- Moderate valuations after recent correction

manufacturing and 3 per cent from others.

The order mix is also diversified geographically with 51 per cent from India, 37 per cent from West Asia and 12 per cent from the rest of the world.

L&T has one of the best engineering execution records. Atal Setu, Kempe Gowda International Airport Terminal 2, Dwarka Expressway, Mumbai Coastal Road, Khargone Thermal Plant, K9 Vajra for Indian Army and many other projects are key execution successes domestically.

Riyadh Metro, Al Rayyan Stadium - Doha, Overhead Transmission Line in Saudi Arabia, Cryostat for ITER France, Flacq Hospital Mauritius, Heat Exchanger in Turkey, Modularised Reformers for Blue H2 project in Rotterdam, The Netherlands, are some key overseas engineering projects.

L&T's newer businesses such as data centres, semiconductor design and digital platforms are still in nascent stage and have not contributed significantly to revenues. However, the company is expanding on this front rapidly

and is getting into hyperscale data centres in Mumbai, Chennai and Bengaluru. On semiconductors, it is in contact with multiple customers for prospective sales.

SERVICES HOLD STEADY

As mentioned earlier, L&T has three listed subsidiaries – LTI-Mindtree, L&T Technology Services and L&T Finance.

The services segment accounts for 28 per cent of the 9MFY26 revenues for the group.

IT and technology services accounted for about 24.2 per cent of the net profits, and financial services for 13.4 per cent in this 9MFY26 period, totalling 37.6 per cent of L&T's overall profits.

In a period that has seen software technology firms hurt by AI disruptions, both the technology firms from the L&T stable have done relatively better, although they, too, will face some disruptions in future, similar to peers.

Revenues are up 11 per cent for 9MFY26 for the IT & technology subsidiaries. EBITDA margin was at 19.8 per cent.

In the financial services firm, income from operations (net revenue) grew 11 per cent and the loan book grew 20 per cent for 9MFY26. Return on assets was healthy at 2.31 per cent, while capital adequacy was solid at 19.1 per cent.

ROBUST FINANCIALS

Since consolidated figures include L&T Financial Services, we take the standalone numbers for L&T to gauge key debt metrics.

The debt-equity ratio for the nine months ended December 2025 was just 0.2, down from 0.38 a year earlier. Interest coverage ratio is healthy at 9.43 times currently versus 6.4 times a year ago.

The falling cost of debt and healthy cash flows towards debt servicing helped the firm.

Any serious escalation in the war that hurts larger parts of West Asia operations in its core businesses and continued disruption from AI in its technology subsidiaries that hurt growth and margins, are risks to this recommendation.

Value on offer, repair underway

INSURANCE. Downside appears relatively protected by valuation and balance-sheet strength of New India Assurance Co.

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

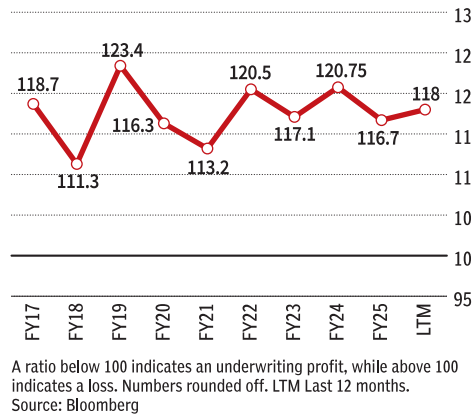
The sharp 43 per cent correction in the stock of government-owned The New India Assurance Company (NIACL) from its 52-week high of ₹214.75 has brought it back into focus. Since late February, when the West Asian conflict escalated, NIACL has corrected around 17 per cent, sharper than listed general insurance peers. The decline appears to reflect concern over NIACL's relatively higher exposure to volatile marine, aviation and overseas books at a time when war-risk premiums and shipping disruption around the Strait of Hormuz have intensified.

At ₹121.85, the over ₹20,000-crore m-cap, the PSU insurer trades at about 0.9 times trailing book, low for a market leader with a 13.4 per cent share in gross direct premium (India). The stock is also at a 25 per cent discount to its five-year average price-to-book multiple of 1.2 times. Private-sector peers such as ICICI Lombard and the recently-listed Go Digit trade at 5.3-6.9 times trailing book value. Listed since November 2017, NIACL is a large, balance-sheet-heavy insurer with scope for recovery, but also a history of uneven underwriting performance. The management has, however, started exiting loss-making business and tightening underwriting, which could support gradual re-rating if early gains sustain. Investors should note that cheap can get cheaper: NIACL had fallen to about 0.7 times book value in July-2022, and further downside cannot be ruled out if operating repair takes longer or external risks worsen. Gradual accumulation on dips makes sense, but expectations should remain measured and the horizon long, at over five years. Below, we explain why.

BUSINESS

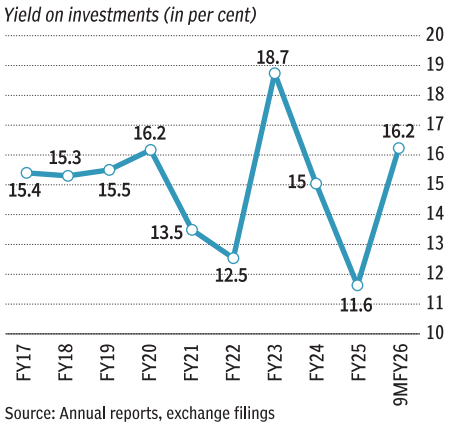
Founded by Sir Dorabji Tata in 1919 and nationalised in 1973, NIACL — owned 85 per cent by the government — remains India's largest general insurer by market share. It has a meaningful presence across segments such

Underwriting profitability trend



A ratio below 100 indicates an underwriting profit, while above 100 indicates a loss. Numbers rounded off. LTM Last 12 months. Source: Bloomberg

Investment income trend



Source: Annual reports, exchange filings

● ACCUMULATE ON DIPS

The New India Assurance Company
₹121.85

WHY

- Trading below book
- Large franchise, strong balance sheet
- Underwriting to improve



Segment-wise performance for 9MFY26

Name	Growth in gross written premium (y-o-y per cent)	Change in incurred claims ratio (y-o-y percentage point)*	#Others includes crop and miscellaneous
Fire^	15.3	13	
Marine^	9	32	
Motor	-1.2	4	
Health including PA	16.2	-2	
Liability	8.5	-8	
Engineering	15.5	-2	
Aviation^	1.1	245	
Others#	7.1	10	

Q3FY26 and 9MFY26, NIACL reported a consolidated PAT of about ₹376 crore and ₹789 crore. Underwriting losses of about ₹1,740 crore and ₹7,051 crore in the two periods were offset by investment income of over ₹2,280 crore and ₹8,600 crore, including capital gains.

NIACL's balance sheet is strong. Assets under management are around ₹1 lakh crore. Cash and equivalents (₹17,700 crore in FY25) have steadily compounded over time (five-year CAGR 9.5 per cent). It offers a dividend yield of about 1.48 per cent.

WORK IN PROGRESS

One of the arguments in favour of the stock is that recent numbers have been distorted by wage revision provisions for employees. The management said wage-related provisions significantly distorted FY26 YTD numbers. These included ₹759 crore in Q3FY26 and ₹1,877 crore in 9MFY26 towards wage arrears and retirement benefits for active employees, besides ₹80 crore and ₹642 crore respectively for retired employees. An additional ₹700-800 crore family pension provision is likely in Q4FY26, after which FY27 numbers

should be free of this overhang.

The management has started the exit or restructuring of loss-making corporate accounts, particularly in segments where pricing did not adequately compensate for risk. This has been accompanied by a pivot towards retail, SME and better-quality risks. In motor insurance — a long-standing weak area — NIACL has cut exposure to high-loss segments, including restricting underwriting in heavy commercial vehicles and rebalancing towards private cars.

In health, which accounts for nearly half the premium mix, the management has been repricing group business, exiting under-priced accounts, raising inspection rates, expanding in-house medical expertise and deploying fraud-detection tools. Early signs of improvement in incurred claims ratios (% of premium used to settle claims) suggest these steps are beginning to show results.

Reinsurance restructuring and tighter underwriting across segments also point to better capital efficiency. Early signs of improvement are visible in health, liability and engineering, where incurred claims ratios have moderated (see table).

Next, NIACL continues to grow faster than the industry in its domestic business, highlighting its ability to balance growth with improving underwriting discipline. In 9MFY26, its domestic gross direct premium grew 13.7 per cent, outpacing industry growth of about 8.7 per cent. Year on year, market share improved from 12.8 per cent to 13.4 per cent. Also, the solvency ratio (ability to absorb losses and meet claims) remains comfortable at about 1.8 times, above the regulatory requirement of 1.5 times. This reduces near-term balance-sheet risk and provides room to absorb shocks.

Risks remain from continued underwriting losses in select segments, large claims in marine and aviation, and external shocks to the international book (about 8 per cent of premium pie). Even so, for investors with a five-year-plus horizon, NIACL can be approached as a gradual accumulate-on-dips idea.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 I am stepping into my 40th year of a wonderful business journey. I have undergone changes in my corporate identity and ownership control in recent years.
- 2 My founder was awarded the Padma Bhushan and served in our Army in his younger years.
- 3 My competitor tried to acquire me when I got into financial trouble. Eventually, the promoters ceded control to a private equity investor, who delisted the company.
- 4 Though I got relisted again with the minimum required public float, non-institutional holding is currently below 5 per cent, and the market continues to price my stock below the offer price.
- 5 While my asset-heavy business model of the past, which delivered low RoE, always received a lower valuation, hopefully new geographies and a new business model under the new management may improve the outlook in future.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

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Last week's stock:
Sharda Cropchem
Last week's winner:
Mohan Kumar Ramasamy

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Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (22,820) and Nifty Bank (52,275) declined 1.3 per cent and 2.2 per cent respectively last week.

The market continues to remain in a bearish phase, driven by FIIs (Foreign Institutional Investors) short build-up, with key technical breakdowns reinforcing the trend.

That said, the decline from here could be gradual rather than panic-driven, owing to continued put writing and a fragile bullish stance among retail participants. Here's our detailed analysis:

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (April) (22,909), after opening last week on a weak note, witnessed a recovery mid-week. But it failed to sustain as the contract faced resistance at 23,500 and resumed its decline.

There are no signs of a bullish reversal on the chart and price action suggests that the downtrend remains intact.

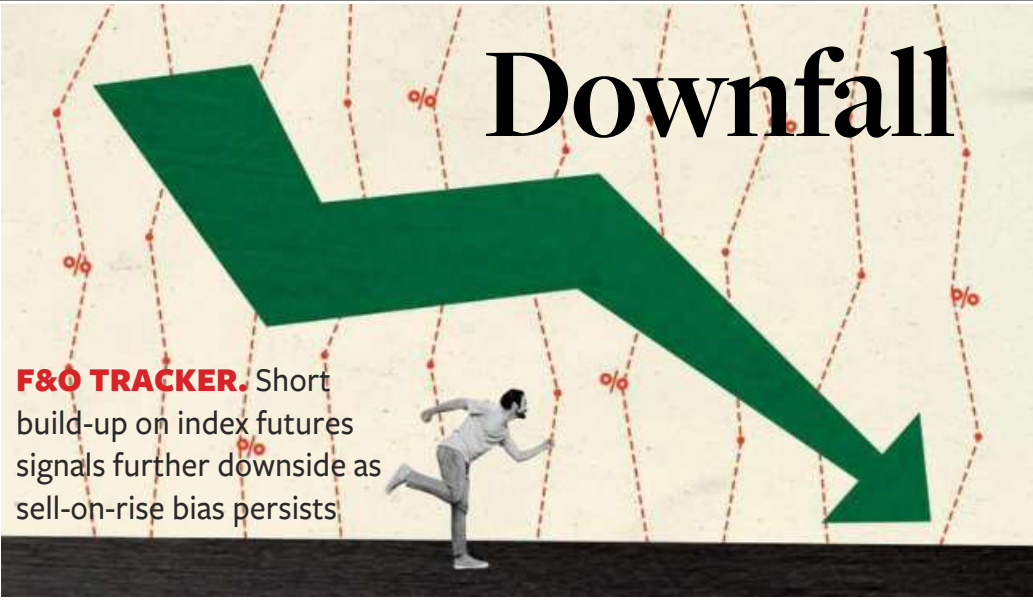
With the nearest notable supports at 22,380 and 22,100, the probability of further decline from the current level is high.

For the sentiment to improve, Nifty futures need to decisively surpass the resistance at 23,500.

Reinforcing the bearish bias, April futures have seen fresh short build-up — as the contract fell 1.6 per cent last week, the outstanding Open Interest (OI) more than tripled to nearly 147 lakh contracts.

On the options front, the Put-Call Ratio (PCR) of April options stood at 1 on Friday.

While this appears neutral, significant call writing at the 23,000 strike (highest OI of 48,666 contracts) indicates that



F&O TRACKER. Short build-up on index futures signals further downside as sell-on-rise bias persists

participants expect recoveries to be capped near this level.

On the downside, notable put OI is concentrated at 22,500 and 22,000 strikes with 26,737 and 42,176 contracts respectively, making these potential support levels.

Based on the aforementioned factors, Nifty futures is likely to remain under pressure in the near term.

A breakout above 23,000, and more importantly 23,500, is required to turn the outlook bullish. Until then, traders can adopt a sell-on-rise strategy.

Strategy: Short Nifty futures (April) at 22,909 and on a rally to 23,300. Place stop-loss at 23,700. Revise the stop-loss to 22,850 when the contract falls to 22,500. Book profits at 22,100.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (April) (52,547), after a sharp sell-off early last week, attempted a recovery.

However, bulls failed to sus-

BROAD TREND

- Call writing caps upside
- Trendline breach weakens Nifty Bank
- Nifty structure remains fragile

tain momentum as the contract faced resistance at 54,500, following which it resumed its decline in line with the broader trend.

The underlying index has breached a key long-term trendline support at 53,450, strengthening the bearish outlook. The corresponding level for April futures stands near 54,000.

Adding to the bearish set-up, Nifty Bank futures has witnessed fresh short build-up — as the contract declined 2.6 per cent last week, the outstanding OI more than doubled to 18.3 lakh contracts.

The PCR of April options stood at 0.86 on Friday. A ratio

below 1 indicates relatively higher call writing compared to puts, suggesting that participants are expecting a downside.

From a technical standpoint, the nearest support levels are at 50,800 and 50,000. Although 52,000 could act as an interim support due to notable put OI (17,860 contracts), the prevailing momentum increases the likelihood of this level being breached.

On the upside, 53,000 and 54,000 act as immediate resistance levels, followed by a strong barrier at 55,000. Only a decisive breakout above 55,000 can improve the outlook.

Overall, both price action and derivatives data suggest a continuation of the downward move in the near term.

Strategy: Short Nifty Bank futures (April) at 52,547 and on a rally to 53,600. Place stop-loss at 55,000. Revise the stop-loss to 52,250 when the contract falls to 51,000. Book profits at 50,000.

Trigger order for options?

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Objective of these orders is to accumulate during sharp dips

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Previously in this column, we discussed why OCO (one cancels other) orders can be useful for exiting option positions. This week, we discuss whether trigger orders are meaningful for initiating option positions.

TIMING MATTERS
It is efficient to set trigger orders to initiate positions in the spot market. For instance, you could place an alert trigger order (ATO) to buy units of a Nifty ETF when the Nifty Index trades below a predefined level. The objective is to accumulate ETF units during sharp dips in the Nifty Index. You are not buying the units for a specific price target nor are you concerned about your trading horizon.

Options are dated contracts and wasting assets. That means an option's time value will decay with each passing day and become zero at expiry. This means timing your position's entry and exit is important. So, going long on a call option because the Nifty Index has declined may not be optimal unless you observe signs



QUICK TIP
It is optimal to buy options on the first sign of a price reversal, not when the Nifty Index moves above a predefined (trigger) price

of a price reversal. Why? It may take a while for the index to reverse and move up by which time the option could expire worthless or could lose significant value because of time decay.

What about breakout trades? While futures contracts are good for breakout trades, as they move

one-to-one with the underlying, options are good for price reversals. This is because the maximum you can lose is the premium paid to initiate the long option position. That means it is optimal to buy options on the first sign of a price reversal, not when the Nifty Index moves above a predefined (trigger) price and offers more conviction of a price reversal. If you use a trigger order for options based on price breakouts, you may have to pay a higher premium as the index would have to move up to trigger the order. That means paying more for time value and, perhaps, larger loss from time

decay. Then, there is another issue. If the Nifty Index were to gap-up on opening, the strike you chose to buy using the trigger order may already be in-the-money (ITM). That would mean paying for the option's intrinsic value as well. The issue is two-fold. One, buying an ITM option may not be meaningful as the intrinsic value is fully priced into the option. And two, as the underlying moves up and the strike become more ITM, its liquidity reduces, leading to mispricing.

OPTIONAL READING
If you cannot initiate trades during market hours, you may have to place after-market orders. The advantage is that the order will not be filled if there is a gap-up in the underlying because of which the option price moves up sharply. Also, the order is valid only for a day.

The flip-side is that limit order may not be filled if your bid is very conservative. That said, after-market orders may be more useful than ATOs for initiating option positions.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Meek recovery

BULLION CUES. Further fall likely; go short

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold (\$4,495/ounce) ended last week flat whereas silver (\$69.70/ounce) gained 2.7 per cent. MCX gold futures (₹1,47,255/10gm) was down 0.5 per cent and MCX silver futures (₹2,27,954/kg) was up 0.5 per cent.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,47,255)
Gold futures (June) opened last Monday with a gap-down and fell to mark an intraday low of ₹1,32,020. But then, the contract recovered in the same session and extended the rise in following sessions too.

However, the rally lacks conviction, and the contract is now facing a barrier at ₹1,50,000. The 38.2 per cent Fibonacci retracement of the recent downtrend coincides at this level, making it a strong resistance.

We expect gold futures to see a decline, potentially to ₹1,32,000. A breach of this can drag it to ₹1,25,000. However, if the contract breaks out of ₹1,50,000, it can move up further to ₹1,58,000.

Trade strategy: Sell gold futures (June) at ₹1,47,300. Target



and stop-loss can be ₹1,32,000 and ₹1,51,000 respectively.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,27,954)
Silver futures (May) began last week with a bearish bias and dropped to a low of ₹1,99,643 on Monday. However, the price recovered after this initial decline.

But the recovery has not turned the outlook positive. There is a strong resistance at ₹2,36,000. Until this level holds, the outlook will remain bearish.

We anticipate a fresh leg of downtrend from the current level, which can drag silver futures to ₹2,00,000 again. A breach of this can lead to a deeper fall, possibly to ₹1,85,000.

Trade strategy: Sell silver futures (May) at ₹2,28,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,90,000 and ₹2,43,000.

Volatile but firm

CRUDE CHECK. Bullish bias on; consider buying

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices saw considerable volatility last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$105.30/barrel) was down 6.1 per cent whereas crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹9,395/barrel) gained a marginal 1.5 per cent.

BRENT FUTURES (\$105.30)
Brent crude oil futures tumbled over 10 per cent last Monday. It then slipped further to a low of \$93.45 on Wednesday. At that point the bears gave up and the bulls took over again, leading to a rally in the second half of last week.

Aiding the rebound was the support band of \$93.50-95. Until this price region stays relevant, the trend will remain bullish.

Brent crude futures is expected to rally from the current level of \$105.30 to touch \$124, a key price level. A breakout of this can take the contract to \$130.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹9,395)
Similar to Brent crude futures, MCX crude oil futures (April)

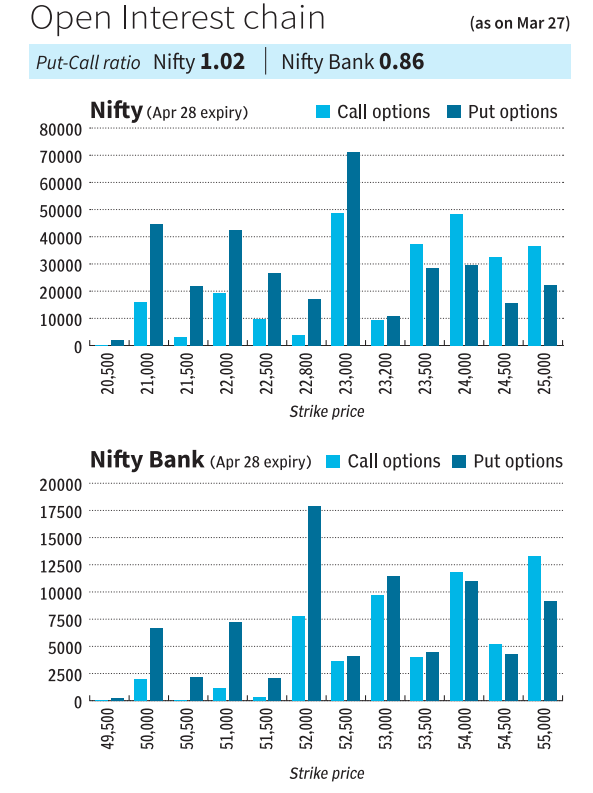
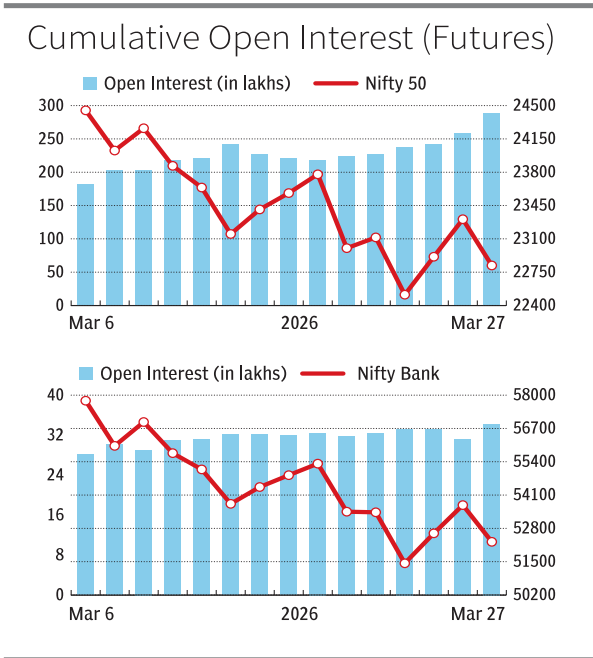


lost about 10 per cent last Monday. But it recovered from the low of ₹8,072 made on Monday and reclaimed the ₹9,000-mark in subsequent sessions. This shows that the bulls only faced a temporary setback.

The chart denotes that the contract has a support at ₹8,000 and the 21-day moving average lies at ₹8,200, effectively making the price band of ₹8,000-8,200 a demand zone. Hence, bulls are expected to be in charge until ₹8,000 holds well.

We expect crude oil futures to rally to ₹10,300 soon. A breakout of this can take it further higher to ₹10,800.

Trade strategy: Go long at ₹9,000 and ₹8,600. Stop-loss can be ₹8,000. On a rally to ₹10,000, revise the stop-loss to ₹9,500. Book profits at ₹10,500.



Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Mar 27	Weekly change %	As on Mar 27	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	61970	31	287333	508
Future Index Short	341437	21	121797	-57
Net Futures	-279467	19	165536	-171
Index Call options Long	756766	16	2980743	356
Index Call options Short	967312	7	2669679	196
Net Call options	-210546	-15	311064	-225
Index Put options Long	1067058	1	2213747	110
Index Put options Short	658579	7	2746340	348
Net Put Options	408479	-7	-532593	-221

FII positioning indicates an expectation that the market may drift lower but not collapse, and not trend strongly in one direction.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Mar 27)				
LODHA	700.20	-12.1	338.7	62.4
BDL	1,136.90	-9.0	140.7	15.0
HCLTECH	1,364.40	2.3	501.6	14.6
360ONE	977.40	-6.1	51.5	13.9
OFSS	6,947.00	5.6	32.0	12.7
FALL (as on Mar 27)				
SYNGENE	415.60	0.2	118.5	-30.7
PREMIEREENE	893.80	3.4	154.9	-27.1
ASTRAL	1,619.10	-0.8	127.2	-23.1
SBICARD	673.95	-2.1	388.7	-20.5
SUPREMEIND	3,747.70	-2.3	28.6	-20.4

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Mar 30)

SAIL

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹) (Weekly change %)	OI	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on Mar 27)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Apr	339.7 (2.7)	2,915 (55)	Long build-up
COPPER	30-Apr	1,150.4 (2.7)	9,314 (18)	Long build-up
CRUDEOIL	20-Apr	9,395.0 (1.5)	15,603 (-6)	Short covering
CRUDEOILM	20-Apr	9,396.0 (1.5)	62,415 (-9)	Long build-up
GOLD	5-Jun	1,47,255.0 (-0.5)	6,011 (52)	Short build-up
GOLDGUINEA	30-Apr	1,17,011.0 (-2.5)	17,399 (51)	Short build-up
GOLDM	5-May	1,45,932.0 (-0.3)	25,008 (41)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Apr	14,656.0 (-2.5)	2,02,194 (42)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	30-Apr	1,46,245.0 (-0.6)	36,997 (47)	Short build-up
LEAD	30-Apr	193.4 (1.3)	139 (28)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	27-Apr	289.7 (0.7)	20,793 (52)	Long build-up
SILVER	5-May	2,27,954.0 (0.5)	5,664 (-9)	Short covering
SILVERM	30-Apr	2,32,112.0 (0.2)	13,565 (-12)	Short covering
SILVERMIC	30-Apr	2,32,271.0 (0.1)	49,221 (-14)	Short covering
ZINC	30-Apr	315.4 (2.7)	2,225 (10)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Mar 27)				
USDINR	28-Apr	95.06 (1.1)	1,460,977 (700)	Long build-up
EURINR	28-Apr	109.72 (1.2)	24,956 (124680)	Long build-up
GBPINR	28-Apr	126.59 (-)	23,160 (-)	-
JPYINR	28-Apr	60 (-)	31 (-)	-

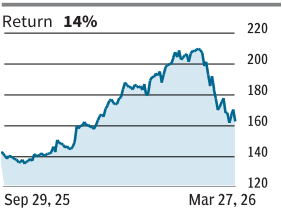
F&O Strategy

Short Ashok Leyland

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The stock of Ashok Leyland (₹163.09) has been on a steady decline since the beginning of March. The resistance at ₹212 triggered the downtrend.

While there was a rebound last week, the stock was unable to get past the hurdle at ₹173. Only a breach of this can turn the outlook positive. Notable resistance above ₹173 is at ₹180. The rally getting rejected at ₹173 itself last week indicates lack of strength in bulls.



The chart shows that the downtrend is intact and as there are no notable signs of a bullish reversal yet, we expect the stock to witness another leg of a decline, possibly to ₹150. A breach of this can take the price lower to ₹144.

Therefore, participants can consider going short. Depending on the risk appetite, one can either short futures or go long on a put option.

Futures: Short Ashok Leyland April futures (₹162.82) if it rises to ₹167. Place stop-loss at ₹175 at first. When the contract falls to ₹158, revise the stop-loss to ₹165. Book profits at ₹152.

Options: Instead of shorting futures, one can take a bearish bet by going long on put options. We recommend buying 150-strike put of April expiry, whose premium stood at ₹3.97 on Friday. Buy if the option price moderates to ₹3.15 with a stop-loss at ₹1.30. Book profits at ₹8.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Short Take

Margin planning

bl. research bureau

The amount of margin (either as funds or securities or combination of both) one should ideally maintain depends upon how one trades. For instance, consider a trader who plans to initiate intraday trade in Nifty futures. Here, the upfront margin requirement to initiate trade will be approximately ₹60,000. In addition to this, one should have enough margin to adjust for possible mark-to-market (MTM) losses.



The daily average true range (ATR) indicator indicates that Nifty 50 moves about 400 points a day (average of last 14 days). So, a trader should know that the index can possibly go 400 points against the direction of this trade in a day. To give more room, one can take it as say 450 points. Should such a move happen, the Nifty futures trade would be at a loss of ₹29,250 (450 points multiplied by lot size of the contract i.e., 65). So, a trader who plans to trade one lot of Nifty futures intraday should at last maintain a margin of ₹89,250 i.e., upfront margin of ₹60,000 plus the MTM margin of ₹29,250.

If the trader plans to hold for one week, the weekly ATR of about 700 points means one should maintain ₹45,500 as MTM margin in addition to the upfront margin, taking the ideal total margin money to ₹1,05,500. Same can be applied for trading in the cash segment too. Note that this is not the only method but a suggestion. Also, note that the margin will go up if you increase the lots.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and the Nifty Bank fell for the fifth consecutive week. Sensex and Nifty were down about 1.3 per cent each. Nifty Bank on the other hand fell over 2 per cent last week.

The benchmark indices witnessed a bounce initially last week but failed to sustain. They fell towards the end of the week giving away all gains. This pattern of moving up in the first half and then falling later is happening for the second consecutive week. It indicates the absence of strong buyers to take the indices higher. This also shows that the overall picture is still weak. That leaves the downside open for the Nifty, Sensex and the Nifty Bank to fall further from here.

However, key supports are coming up which will need a close watch. We will have to wait and see if the indices are managing to bounce back from these supports or not.

SELLING SPREE
Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) sold Indian equities for the fourth consecutive week. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$2.73 billion. The month of March has seen an outflow of about \$12.3 billion.

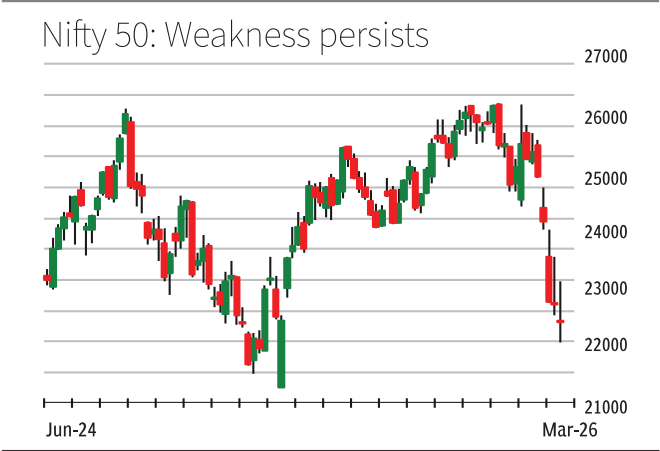
NIFTY 50 (22,819.60)
Short-term view: The weakness persists. The downside remains open to see 22,300-22,200. A bounce from there can take the Nifty higher to 23,500-23,700 or 24,000. This can keep the index in a range of 22,200-24,000 for some time.

A rise above 24,000 is needed ideally to get some relief. Nifty will come under more selling pressure if it breaks below 22,200. If that happens, 21,700 can be seen on the downside.

Our preference will be to see the Nifty sustaining above 22,200 and rise back to 23,500-23,700.

Medium-term view: The region between 22,200-22,000 will continue to be the crucial support. A bounce from there and a subsequent rise above 24,000 will be bullish to revisit 26,000-26,400. That will also keep the broader sideways range intact.

As mentioned last week, Nifty has to breach 26,400 to bring



back the bullish outlook of seeing 28,000 and 30,000 on the upside. For this to happen, Nifty has to sustain above 22,000. Nifty will come under danger of further fall only if it breaks below 22,000 and declines below 21,700 eventually.

NIFTY BANK (52,274.60)
Short-term view: An immediate support is at 52,200. Nifty Bank index looks vulnerable to break this support. Such a break can drag it down to 50,800-50,500 and not beyond that.

A bounce from the 50,800-50,500 support zone can take the Nifty Bank index higher to 54,000 again. A decisive break above 54,000 is needed to get some relief.

Medium-term view: The region around 50,500 is a crucial support. A bounce from there and a subsequent rise above

INDEX OUTLOOK. Benchmark indices not seeing strong follow-through buying

- CRUCIAL SUPPORTS**
- Nifty 50: 22,200, 22,000
 - Sensex: 72,250, 72,000
 - Nifty Bank: 50,800, 50,500

Medium-term view: As mentioned last week, 72,250 is a crucial support. We further stress that a bounce from 72,250 and a subsequent rise above 77,500 will be bullish. It can then take the Sensex higher to 85,000-86,000 in the medium term. An eventual rise above 86,000 will then bring back the earlier bullish view of seeing 90,000 and 98,000-99,000 in the long term.

Sensex has to decline below 72,000 to come under the risk of further fall.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (19,952.75)
The fall to 19,200 almost happened last week. The index touched a low of 19,384.45 and has risen back. There is no major change in the view. Important support is in the 19,200-19,000 region which can be tested in the short term.

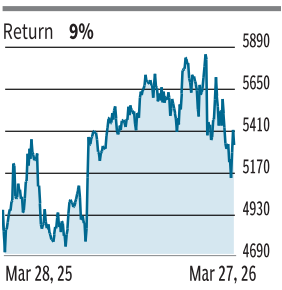
We expect the Nifty Midcap 150 index to sustain above 19,000 and rise back to 21,000 again.

A subsequent rise above 21,000 will then take the index higher to 22,800 over the medium term. From a big picture,

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU bl. research bureau

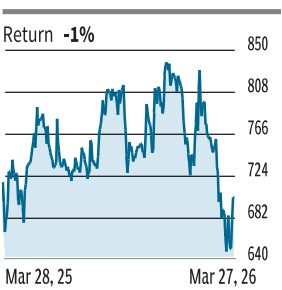
Alkem Laboratories (₹5,343.50)
Outlook remains negative



The stock of Alkem Laboratories has been in a downtrend for over two months now. The bears capitalised the barrier at ₹5,900 and triggered the sell-off in mid-January. The price action shows that negative bias remains and the chances for further decline are high. Although ₹5,000 can act as a psychological support, the nearest strong support can only be seen at ₹4,750.

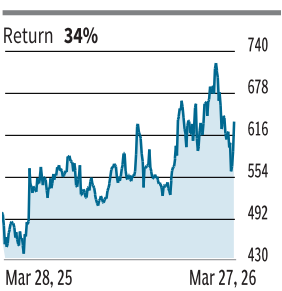
We forecast the price to decline to this level in the coming weeks. So, we suggest initiating a fresh short position at ₹5,350. Place stop-loss at ₹5,520. When price slips to ₹5,000 and ₹4,850, revise the stop-loss to ₹5,200 and ₹5,000 respectively. Exit at ₹4,750.

Century Plyboards (India) (₹701.15)
Strong base ahead



The stock of Century Plyboards (India) appreciated 8 per cent last week. While it began last week on the back foot, the scrip reversed the direction soon. The base at ₹625 arrested the fall and aided an upturn. This level has been valid since August 2023, showing that it is a strong base. Although ₹725 is a minor hurdle, the noticeable resistance is at ₹850. That said, we expect the stock to surpass this level and touch ₹900 over the medium term. Buy at ₹700 and ₹650. Keep a stop-loss at ₹585. When the stock rises to ₹775 and ₹850, alter the stop-loss to ₹710 and ₹820 respectively. Exit at ₹900.

Graphite India (₹639.65)
Bounces off a key average



The stock of Graphite India has been in an uptrend over the last one year. After facing some moderation recently, it rebounded from the 50-week moving average last week. Notably, it is the third bounce off this average in the last eight months and the price has risen well in the past two occasions. Given this and that the broader trend is bullish, the chances for a rally is high. Buy the stock now at ₹639 and accumulate at ₹590. Place initial stop-loss at ₹540. When the price touches ₹700, raise the stop-loss to ₹640. Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹700 when the stock hits ₹750. Book profits at ₹800.

Knocked down

US MARKET OUTLOOK. US benchmark indices can fall further

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite indices were beaten down for the fifth consecutive week. The Dow Jones fell 0.9 per cent. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index were down 2.1 per cent and 3.2 per cent respectively.

The Dow Jones has tumbled about 9 per cent in the last five weeks. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index have declined 7.8 per cent and 8.5 per cent respectively over the same period.

The Dow Jones is coming close to a key support. But the S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite are still vulnerable to fall more.

The weakness in these two indices may keep the Dow Jones vulnerable to break below its upcoming support. We will have to wait and see what happens.

The dollar index remained stable last week while the Treasury Yields continued to rise.

DOW JONES (45,166.64)
A crucial support is in the 45,000-44,900 region. A bounce from this support zone can give some relief for the Dow Jones. That in turn can trigger a corrective rise to 46,000-46,500.

But, there needs to be some caution since the other two benchmark indices are looking weak. So, the chances of the Dow breaking below 44,900 cannot be ruled out. If that happens, then the current fall can extend to 44,000.

The price action in the 45,000-44,900 region will need a close watch this week.

S&P 500 (6,368.85)
The fall to 6,380 mentioned last week has happened as expected. The S&P 500 index touched a low of 6,356.

Strong resistance is now in the 6,450-6,470 region which can cap the upside if there is an intermediate bounce.

As long as the index trades below 6,470, the outlook will remain bearish. The S&P 500 index can fall to 6,200-6,180 from here.

The index has to rise above 6,500 in order to get some relief.



● **BULLISH VIEW INTACT**

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield sustained well above 4.3 per cent and keeps intact our bullish view of seeing a rise to 4.6 per cent

But that looks unlikely now.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (20,948.36)
Last week we had expected a corrective bounce from 21,200 first and then a fresh fall breaking below 21,200. But instead, the NASDAQ Composite index has declined below 21,200 without seeing a corrective rise. That keeps intact our broader bearish view.

Immediate resistance is around 21,300. Above that 21,700-22,000 will be the next strong resistance zone. The chances are high for the index to remain below 21,300 itself. NASDAQ Composite index can fall to 20,300 and even 19,800 in the coming weeks.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK
The dollar index (100.19) remained stable and range-bound.

The index has been oscillating between 98.85 and 100.50 over the last couple of weeks.

The bias remains positive. Support is in the 99-98.50 region which is holding very well. The dollar index can rise to 101-101.20 in the coming weeks.

A decisive break above 101.20 can boost the momentum. Such a break can take the dollar index higher to 103-104.

Failure to breach 101.20 can drag the index down to 100-99.50.

Our preference is to see the dollar index rising above 101.20 if not immediately but eventually.

TREASURY YIELD
The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.43 per cent) has sustained well above 4.3 per cent and has risen further as expected. That keeps intact our broader bullish view.

Immediate resistance is at 4.45 per cent. A decisive break above this resistance can take the US 10Yr Treasury Yield higher to 4.6 per cent in the coming weeks.

The yield has to decline below 4.3 per cent to turn the outlook negative. But that looks less likely for now. As such the rise to 4.6 per cent is likely to happen first.

Chart-Gazing · bl · 7

TECH QUERY

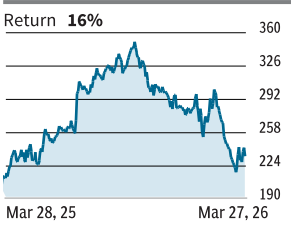


GURUMURTHY K
bl. research bureau

I have shares of Eternal (Zomato) bought at ₹285. What is the outlook?

Diyashana, Chennai

Eternal (₹233): The stock has recently declined below an important support at ₹245. The broader uptrend is getting reversed. Cluster of resistance is in the



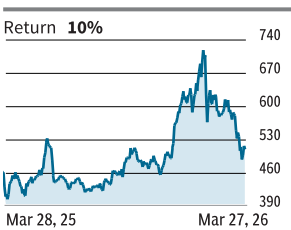
₹250-280 region. The stock has to breach ₹280 and then rise above ₹300 subsequently to become bullish again. But that looks less likely. Such a rise may need some strong positive trigger. As long as the stock stays below ₹280, the bias will remain negative. Support

is at ₹206. A break below ₹206 will increase the downside pressure. Such a break can drag Eternal (Zomato) share price down to ₹175-170 in the coming months. Since the stock can fall more from here, it is better to exit the stock now and accept the loss.

I have Hindustan Zinc shares. What is the outlook? What should I do?

AC Jha

Hindustan Zinc (₹510): As you have not given the purchase price, it is difficult to advise on what to do. Here's a broader outlook. You can take a call accordingly. Structurally the stock is in an uptrend. But



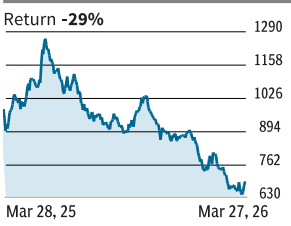
the rally has faded over the last couple of years. That leaves the short-term picture unclear. Supports are at ₹490 and ₹380. Resistance is around ₹740. The stock can oscillate in a wide range of ₹380-740 for some time now. A strong break

above ₹740 is needed to regain the momentum. Only then the upside will open up for a rise to ₹1,000 and higher levels. That seems to be not happening immediately. Considering the time factor, it is better to exit the stock now.

I have Brigade Enterprises shares. My purchase price is ₹842. What is the long-term outlook?

UC Prabhu

Brigade Enterprises (₹689): The trend is down since September 2024. Strong resistance is in the ₹800-850 region. As long as the stock stays below this resistance, the downtrend will remain intact. The downside is



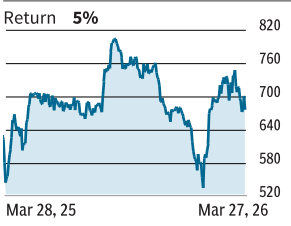
open to see ₹550-520. A break below it will increase the danger of the stock tumbling towards ₹400. Ideally, the stock has to breach ₹850 to indicate a trend reversal. But that looks unlikely. Accept the loss and exit the stock. We always insist the importance of

having a stop-loss to minimise the loss. So, whenever you enter any trade, have a stop-loss in place. Most importantly, make sure to adhere to it.

I have CG Power and Industrial Solutions bought at ₹120. Can I hold it for another two years?

Gaurav Sood, New Delhi

CG Power and Industrial Solutions (₹668): You have made a very good buy. But most important now is to protect your profits. Keep a stop-loss at ₹440 and hold the stock. The trend is up and strong. The stock is now consolidating within the uptrend. Supports are at ₹500 and ₹460. Resistance is around ₹785. A strong



break above it can boost the momentum. Such a break can take the share price higher to ₹1,400-1,500 in the coming months. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹760 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹860. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹980 and ₹1,210 when the

share price touches ₹1,150 and ₹1,360 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹1,450.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all!" So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

1 Emcure Pharmaceuticals

2 Honasa Consumer

3 Aurobindo Pharma

4 ONGC

5 Aster DM Healthcare

Last week's prize winner
Chumki Banerjee

Last week's winning stock
Ather Energy

Closing price (Mar 20)
₹783.25

Closing price (Mar 27)
₹796.45

Return:
1.69 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50, declined about a 1.3 per cent each last week. BSE IT and BSE Teck were the top performers, delivering 0.8 per cent and 0.4 per cent, respectively. BSE Realty and BSE PSU were the worst performers, falling 3.9 per cent and 2.8 per cent, respectively.

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE

	Nifty 50		Sensex		Auto		Bankex		Capital Goods		Consumer Durables		FMCG		Healthcare		IT		Metal		Oil & Gas		Power		PSU		Realty		Teck	
P/E	20.0		20.2		31.3		14.0		12.9		14.7		32.0		37.7		21.5		19.4		8.6		32.0		11.1		32.8		25.2	
P/BV	3.1		4.0		5.9		2.1		19.4		0.6		1.6		0.5		1.6		3.0		1.2		4.3		2.2		4.2		7.5	
Dividend Yield	1.4		1.2		1.3		1.2		0.5		0.6		1.6		0.5		1.6		3.6		1.6		4.2		2.4		0.5		2.2	
Weekly Return (%)	-1.3 ▼		-1.3 ▼		-1.5 ▼		-2.3 ▼		-2.4 ▼		-1.9 ▼		-1.3 ▼		0.3 ▲		0.8 ▲		-2.3 ▼		-1.2 ▼		-1.8 ▼		-2.8 ▼		-3.9 ▼		0.4 ▲	
Monthly Return (%)	-9.4 ▼		-9.5 ▼		-13.4 ▼		-13.7 ▼		-6.7 ▼		-9.3 ▼		-8.8 ▼		-3.4 ▼		-4.4 ▼		-8.9 ▼		-13.3 ▼		-2.4 ▼		-10.3 ▼		-14.2 ▼		-3.7 ▼	
Annual Return (%)	-3.3 ▼		-5.2 ▼		11.7 ▲		-0.9 ▼		4.6 ▲		-1.8 ▼		-11.5 ▼		2.3 ▲		-22.6 ▼		19.0 ▲		2.4 ▲		2.2 ▲		10.5 ▲		-22.3 ▼		-14.5 ▼	

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Y-High	Y-Low
360 ONE [1]	977.4	29.0	33.7	4.3	202512	51.5	18.4	22.1	10.0	-6.1	14.3	0.0	1273.0	766.1
3M India	3098.1	542.7	56.9	16.2	204206	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	-4.1	39.8	0.0	3830.0	2680.1
A B B [2]	6106.7	78.8	77.5	16.5	202512	5.1	-18.3	27.4	39.4	-3.0	9.8	0.1	6555.0	4590.1
A B Real Estate	1131.2	-19.0		3.3	202512	-59.8	-389.2	-52.3	-317.9	-3.0	-0.2	1.0	2535.0	1080.1
Aadhar Hsg. Fin.	455.6	23.9	19.0	2.9	202512	18.2	-22.7	18.7	20.0	1.0	11.4	2.8	547.8	402.1
Aarti Industries [5]	417.9	10.2	40.8	2.7	202512	25.8	221.7	13.3	1.6	-2.1	6.2	0.7	494.0	338.2
AAVAS Finance	1109.8	11.9	17.9	2.3	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	0.9	9.9	3.2	2238.4	1002.1
Abbott India	26155.4	71.3	36.5	3.9	202512	6.8	4.2	9.3	14.2	-2.2	45.0	0.0	53921.6	25350.0
ACC [1]	1314.3	134.0	9.8	1.2	202512	8.6	-65.4	16.4	4.7	-4.9	17.9	0.0	2123.3	1306.0
ACME Solar Hold.	269.3	8.3	32.5	3.4	202512	42.3	-3.7	61.7	319.0	9.2	7.4	2.8	324.3	172.9
Action Const.Eng.	781.3	35.5	22.0	5.2	202512	-2.3	4.2	8.6	-5.8	0.0	139.0	75.0	140.0	394.0
Adani Energy Sol	956.8	18.7	51.2	4.9	202512	15.4	17	20.0	4.8	-5.3	10.1	0.2	12667.3	755.5
Adani Enterpr.	1822.9	25.5	72.0	4.4	202512	8.6	1823.5	-5.1	-15.4	-5.4	9.0	1.8	2612.8	1814.1
Adani Green [1]	832.5	10.4	80.4	7.0	202512	7.6	-106.8	14.8	10.1	-3.6	9.4	6.4	1179.2	764.1
Adani Ports [2]	1337.6	54.8	24.4	3.7	202512	21.9	24.9	26.3	18.9	-2.0	14.0	0.9	1584.0	1041.1
Adani Power [2]	1159.9	5.9	25.9	5.1	202512	-8.9	-18.9	-1.9	-12.2	-1.6	21.2	0.7	182.8	94.4
Adani Total Gas [1]	529.5	5.8	90.7	12.9	202512	16.4	11.4	17.7	-3.9	-4.0	17.4	0.4	79.4	453.5
Aditya Bkr. Fias. [5]	902.8	35.3	25.6	7.3	202512	7.4	21.0	12.0	11.8	-4.5	35.5	0.0	1044.4	564.1
Aditya Bkr. Fias.	571.1	6.2	1.1	202512	1.9	-215.9	8.7	4.5	-4.7	0.0	1.3	17.7	10.0	57.0
Aditya Birla Cap.	305.8	13.5	22.6	2.5	202512	2.7	40.5	13.0	-3.2	-1.8	1.4	5.4	369.3	169.6
Aegis Logistics [1]	611.7	21.9	27.9	3.6	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	0.0	14.5	0.9	946.5	576.0
Aether Industri.	1171.4	16.9	69.5	6.7	202512	44.4	46.2	52.7	93.2	0.9	9.7	0.1	1250.0	723.2
Affcons Infrastr.	281.8	13.9	20.3	1.9	202512	-7.3	5.7	-3.1	-1.9	1.0	14.4	0.6	490.0	265.9
Affle [2]	1446.4	21.1	64.4	6.3	202512	19.2	19.1	19.2	19.7	12.5	16.6	0.1	4128.6	1221.1
AIA Engineering [2]	3446.5	124.8	27.6	4.4	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	-0.6	19.1	0.1	2000.0	3006.0
Ajanta Pharma [2]	2821.5	81.2	34.7	8.2	202512	20.0	17.6	14.8	13.0	-3.2	32.0	0.0	3158.2	2021.0
AKZO Nobel	2943.7	83.0	35.5	6.0	202512	-13.6	12.5	-7.0	12.1	-2.2	39.1	0.1	3909.3	2649.1
Alkermes Pharma [2]	354.8	28.5	20.0	2.5	202512	10.8	21.0	13.2	11.6	-0.5	12.1	0.2	1107.9	1024.0
Alkem Lab [2]	5345.9	200.9	26.6	4.8	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	11.0	1.6	20.0	0.1	5933.0	4627.9
Alkyl Amines [2]	1291.4	35.3	36.6	4.6	202512	-4.6	-3.4	-0.5	-1.2	-0.1	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1201.1
Allied Blenders [2]	397.0	9.6	41.4	7.1	202512	3.0	19.5	14.0	135.6	-2.4	10.0	0.9	720.0	278.9
Ally Health [1]	118.9	1.9	61.5	1.5	202512	1.2	42.9	-30.2	-2.7	-3.5	23.6	0.1	2386.8	1321.1
Amara Raja Enter.	701.7	37.4	18.7	1.7	202512	4.2	22.2	5.1	26.8	-7.7	15.6	0.0	1095.9	698.2
Amar Rubber	6598.1	66.0	99.9	6.4	202512	37.9	26.4	30.7	4.6	-0.8	13.5	0.8	8625.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cements [2]	409.9	15.7	26.1	1.8	202512	9.2	89.9	16.4	-8.7	-2.8	12.7	0.0	625.0	394.0
Ambuja Bathi Wala [5]	3029.2	44.1	68.7	31.1	202512	-22.2	29.7	20.3	29.4	1.0	56.8	0.1	3323.9	1624.0
Anant Raj [2]	437.3	14.6	29.9	2.9	202512	20.0	30.8	22.6	36.8	-6.1	10.9	0.1	744.1	366.2
Angel One [1]	235.0	8.5	27.8	3.7	202512	5.8	-4.6	-14.6	-42.5	1.7	25.8	0.7	328.3	205.7
Apd Indrs. [1]	10589.1	246.9	42.9	8.8	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	22.8	9.5	32.6	0.1	11641.8	6760.1
Apoll Apollo Tubes [2]	21.2	0.1	11.0	1.5	202512	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	0.2	20.0	13.0	1.0	1.0
Apollo Hospitals [5]	7548.4	126.3	59.8	12.0	202512	17.2	38.8	14.5	38.6	-2.5	17.5	0.6	8099.0	6433.1
Apollo Tyres [1]	411.7	23.0	17.9	1.7	202512	11.8	43.4	6.2	8.3	-2.1	10.9	0.3	540.3	368.0
Apus Value Hou.	197.9	17.8	11.1	2.1	202512	23.0	24.0	28.1	25.5	-5.2	15.1	1.5	364.9	197.1
Asahi India Glas [1]	13.3	12.3	66.1	5.6	202512	-4.4	-32.8	-4.7	-0.7	0.0	13.1	0.9	1073.0	574.3
Ashok Leyland [1]	163.0	6.2	26.4	7.6	202512	23.6	36.2	13.4	30.1	-3.5	14.9	0.3	215.4	95.2
Asster Dms [1]	2207.2	42.6	51.8	10.8	202512	3.9	5.7	1.3	-6.4	-0.5	24.4	0.1	2385.5	2116.0
Asian DM Health.	666.4	7.0	95.0	8.3	202512	12.9	-10.1	8.5	38.5	6.2	11.6	0.5	720.0	431.3
Astral [1]	1620.6	19.2	84.5	11.5	202512	10.3	5.2	6.7	-2.1	-0.7	20.8	0.1	1768.0	1235.0
Astrazeneca Phar	7946.1	48.9	95.5	19.8	202512	38.5	19.8	24.6	24.6	-8.3	29.3	0.0	1300.2	629.0
Ather Energy [1]	796.5	-16.9	11.2	202512	50.2	-140.2	50.9	-25.0	1.7	0.0	1.1	82.0	26.0	1.0
Atul [2]	6236.4	201.8	30.9	3.1	202512	11.1	47.8	13.3	42.9	0.0	12.8	0.0	7793.0	4882.0
AU Small Finance	883.1	30.9	28.6	3.6	202512	14.9	26.3	22.3	13.6	-1.8	0.0	0.0	1038.8	498.1
Aurobindo Pharma	1718.8	44.1	21.6	4.7	202512	9.0	12.9	8.3	-0.7	-1.7	14.2	0.2	1330.9	99.4
Autum Invest [1]	486.8	42.8	11.4	2.5	202512	-22.5	-70.2	-16.0	-9.5	-1.1	29.7	0.1	683.5	271.2
Avenue Super.	3908.9	44.0	88.8	11.1	202512	13.3	18.3	15.4	5.3	3.8	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7
AVL Agra Busine.	185.4	7.4	25.1	3.0	202512	10.5	-30.0	21.8	-19.5	-3.4	19.8	0.3	291.3	171.2
Axis Bank [2]	1205.2	84.5	14.3	1.8	202512	-4.8	4.0	4.5	-6.8	0.1	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1032.5

BHEL [2]	254.9	2.3	109.0	3.6	202512	16.4	189.8	10.4	56.9	-2.7	3.2	0.4	305.9	193.0
Bajaj Auto	282.6	57.6	4.9	1.3	202512	3.5	90.0	0.5	78.3	1.8	15.7	0.7	391.9	263.0
Bajaj Finance [1]	8902.7	319.9	27.8	7.3	202512	21.2	27.8	14.8	18.7	-1.7	28.1	0.2	10186.6	7088.3
Bajaj Finserv [1]	844.4	29.3	28.8	5.1	202512	18.4	-2.1	20.7	14.0	1.7	28.1	0.2	10186.6	7088.3
Bajaj Holdings	1694.6	62.1	27.3	3.6	202512	24.9	11.6	15.6	15.9	-0.9	12.4	4.9	214.9	1660.1
Bajaj Housing	9149.2	660.2	13.9	1.5	202512	127.6	15.3	-34.1	-2.2	-3.9	11.5	0.0	14873.2	9100.0
Bajaj Securities [2]	45.6	3.0	25.4	3.0	202512	18.2	18.9	27.1	-6.9	9.5	4.7	13.7	17.0	75.0
Balaram Chini	211.9	29.6	7.1	1.5	202512	16.7	-15.0	-26.9	15.0	1.0	11.1	0.6	270.0	150.0
Bandhan Bank	796.6	22.2	22.4	2.6	202512	22.0	61.0	15.4	9.0	2.1	11.1	0.6	62.0	33.4
Bank of Baroda [2]	148.7	6.3	23.8	1.0	202512	-0.9	-51.8	0.0	-59.4	-6.2	0.0	0.0	19.2	13.4
Bank of India	260.0	37.6	6.9	0.8	202512	3.2	4.4	4.7	-4.7	-7.2	0.0	0.0	32.6	21.2
Bank of Maharashtra	145.0	22.4	6.5	0.9	202512	6.0	6.7	7.9	19.7	-3.7	0.0	0.0	17.8	10.1
BAOF India	84.4	8.4	7.7	0.8	202512	16.7	27.4	19.3	22.3	0.0	0.0	0.0	17.8	10.1
BASF India	3300.7	84.3	39.2	3.8	202512	6.3	0.9	-1.9	-39.7	-0.7	17.9	0.1	5418.2	2906.9
Bata India [5]	632.7	14.9	42.4	5.3	202512	2.8	9.0	-0.6	-23.4	-4.6	14.6	0.9	130.1	62.2
Bayer Crop Sci	4493.1	149.2	30.1	6.5	202512	4.6	179.8	7.7	28.7	-4.8	23.8	0.0	6540.0	4276.9
Bayer India	498.9	48.9	10.2	0.9	202512	1.7	19.7	4.7	19.7	-4.7	0.0	0.0	17.8	10.1
Berger Paints [1]	415.0	9.6	43.2	7.7	202512	0.3	5.1	3.1	-1.7	-0.4	24.8	0.1	60.4	39.1
Bharti Dynamics [5]	1137.1	15.8	71.9	9.9	202512	-31.4	-50.4	57.2	2.5	-9.0	10.2	0.0	209.6	112.2
Bharti Electronics [1]	404.8	8.2	49.6	13.7	202512	24.0	20.5	14.5	59.0	-0.5	36.9	0.0	47.3	25.2
Bharti Network [1]	70.4	7.0	10.0	1.4	202512	1.4	11.3	18.2	18.2	1.7	0.0	0.0	17.8	10.1
Bharti Airtel [5]	1842.2	50.4	36.6	9.5	202512	19.6	-12.1	25.0	58.5	-0.2	14.3	2.2	217.4	166.9
Bharti Hexacom [5]	1504.3	35.2	42.7	10.2	202512	4.8	48.7	13.6	37.8	-5.1	16.5	1.5	205.0	122.5
Bikaji Foods [1]	615.1	10.5	62.0	12.0	202512	11.2	11.7	13.9	83.8	-2.1	18.4	0.2	62.0	39.1
Birla Com. [1]	370.1	5.1	73.2	1.6	202512	9.1	173.6	14.4	5.9	-2.8	6.6	0.0	250.0	295.3
Birla Corp.	871.2	74.2	11.7	1.1	202512	4.3	141.6	6.4	151.7	6.9	7.2	0.6	153.7	73.9
Birlsoft Ltd [1]	326.6	17.5	19.3	2.5	202512	-1.1	-2.7	-2.6	-15.1	-6.3	20.8	0.0	47.3	32.0
BLS International [1]	253.1	16.5	16.0	4.8	202512	43.6	34.8	47.6	41.9	4.0	39.0	0.1	42.9	21.8
Bombay Dye & Exports	480.6	12.5	39.5	7.0	202512	6.9	30.1	7.1	5.7	-5.0	11.7	0.0	72.2	48.2
Bombay Dye & Exports [2]	480.6	12.5	39.5	7.0	202512	6.9	30.1	7.1	5.7	-5.0	11.7	0.0	72.2	48.2
Blue Star [2]	1675.1	26.0	64.4	11.1	202512	4.2	-2.0	9.5	-2.6	-1.9	25.8	0.1	23.6	15.2
Bosch	2962.9	783.8	3.78	0.2	202512	9.4	7.9	11.3	14.2	-2.5	20.5	0.0	4189.4	3259.8
Brainbees Soluit. [2]	22.4	-3.0	2.5	202512	11.6	-77.0	12.4	-3.4	-10.5	0.0	0.4	43.8	27.7	
Bratara [1]	22.2	-3.0	2.5	202512	11.6	-77.0	12.4	-3.4	-10.5	0.0	0.4	43.8	27.7	
Britannia Inds. [1]	5500.4	100.3	54.9	35.5	202512	9.5	16.9	8.0	11.0	-2.1	51.9	0.4	63.7	45.2



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Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Diabetes treatment options recently received a boost with multiple launches of generic semaglutide, a leading class of drug (GLP-1) for diabetes. The weight loss variant of the same drug being available also contributed to the social media buzz. Amidst the heightened awareness, we highlight health insurance options for existing diabetic population and how they could benefit from health insurance. Health insurers generally curtail the options for policyholders with pre-existing disease (PED) with a three-year waiting period. This remains largely true for most of the policies. But there are options in the insurance marketplace, which extend insurance cover to existing diabetes patients and do so without an extended waiting period. We highlight the policies and compare it on price and features of a normal policy.

SWEET PILL
The primary reason for consid-

ering a diabetes variant of health insurance should be to improve the chances of policy issuance for prospective policyholders with diabetes. It must be noted that IRDAI in its changes announced in 2024-25 has mandated insurance for all. This implies that even PED cases must be issued a policy. But by considering the specific diabetes variant, policyholders can interact with a willing seller that is already serving a similar diabetic pool and has designed the cost, coverage and other features including medical checks proactively. Few policies like that of Aditya Birla also announce 100 per cent issuance for their plans. Pre-policy medical checks could be covered by the provider or shared with the buyer based on the policy. The other reason to consider the diabetes variant should be to lower the PED waiting periods which is normally three years. Diabetes is characterised by elevated blood glucose which over time impacts cardiovascular system, kidney function, or neuropathy. With such broad range of risk, ensuring the pro-

OVERVIEW

- Insurance underwriting is tuned to the diabetic population
- Plans cover for pre- and post-hospitalisation care where expensive insulins are covered
- PED waiting period can be reduced to a minimum

tection net of health insurance early can be crucial. A reduction in PED for diabetes-related conditions can be achieved with targeted health insurance policies. The plans cover pre- and post-hospitalisation care as a normal practice. This assumes significance for diabetes-related ailments where potent insulin prescribed during treatment may be cost-prohibitive but covered under in-patient hospitalisation.

DIABETES POLICIES
Star Health offers Diabetes Safe Plan-B which costs ₹21,000 for a 40-year-old male with diabetes,

type I or type II. A plan for the same condition but without any PED would cost ₹7,357 per year. The premium plan for diabetes patients who are on insulin for chronic disease offers an year in PED waiting for diabetes complications compared to the 3-year waiting period for other PEDs. The plan, though, offers few other additional features; there is no renewal bonus and restoration of cover is limited to once a year for the sum insured and for illness unrelated to illness in the policy period. The plan offers no e-consultation, but includes outpatient consultations cover of ₹5,000 per year in the base plan. This assumes significance as the need for OPD consultations is relatively higher in diabetes. Manipal Cigna's Prime Active plan covers diabetes and several other chronic conditions (obesity, asthma, hypertension) from the 91st day even when it is a PED. The plan costs ₹13,447 per year for the same (40-year-old male with diabetes as a PED). The plan even offers both renewal bonus and restoration benefit comparable to market

standards (doubling in renewal and unlimited restoration a year). The plan includes unlimited tele-consultations. Care Supreme Direct from Care Health Insurance offers an add-on rider which can reduce the PED waiting period for diabetes from 3 years to 30 days. The base policy cost of ₹8,284 alongside the add-on cost of ₹2,500 will allow for such lower waiting times. The aforementioned plans are for diabetes patients. Aditya Birla health plans (Activ Health Platinum Essential for instance) may include an option to upgrade chronic management programme if diabetes is diagnosed after buying the policy and is not a pre-existing condition. The actual details of coverage and waiting times can be explored after purchasing the policy. These plans encourage patients with diabetes to purchase insurance and lower waiting times for diabetes PED for a positive outcome. Policyholders may also consider potent OPD options in ICICI Elevate or Tata AIG Medicare but will have to undergo the 3-year waiting period for OPD coverage.

INSURANCE QUERY.



MADHU BURUGUPALLI

I am a 38-year-old software engineer with a term insurance policy of ₹1 crore that I purchased five years ago. My wife is a homemaker; my family has grown with two children aged 3 and 1; we've moved to a larger home with a substantial mortgage. Given these significant life changes, I'm concerned that my current coverage may no longer be sufficient. How should I reassess my insurance needs considering factors such as increased living expenses?

Karan

Life in the late 30s often marks a clear shift in priorities. While career growth typically brings higher income and stability, it also coincides with a sharp increase in financial responsibilities. A single-income household and a sizeable home loan further compound these responsibilities and materially alter the risk landscape. A term cover that felt adequate five years ago may no longer fully reflect today's obligations, making it essential to revisit your life insurance cover. To determine whether you are underinsured, it is important to adopt a comprehensive protection assessment;

one that goes beyond simple income multiples and instead evaluates your actual financial landscape, including liabilities, dependents, lifestyle costs, and future goals.

PILLARS OF REASSESSMENT
When recalculating an adequate life insurance cover, consider these four critical areas:
Financial liability: Your mortgage is now your largest liability. In the event of an untimely demise, your insurance should first ensure that your family can keep their home. Your cover should, at a minimum, equal your outstanding loan balance.
Income replacement: As your wife is a homemaker, she relies on your earning capacity to manage daily living expenses. Calculate your annual household expenses (adjusted for inflation) and multiply them by the number of years until your youngest child reaches financial independence.
Future milestones: With children aged 3 and 1, you are looking at around two decades of education costs. Higher education in India (and abroad) sees significant inflation. Your policy should include a corpus specifically earmarked for their education.
"Safety net" buffer: This accounts for immediate expenses such as medical bills, and essential administrative expenses and an emergency fund for your spouse to navigate life without



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immediate financial stress.

CURRENT NEED
Begin by evaluating how much life insurance coverage you need today, not what felt adequate a few years ago. Take into account your home loan, household expenses, rising living costs due to inflation, your children's future needs, and the years your family would depend on your income. This helps to arrive at a realistic level of financial protection.
EXISTING POLICY
Next, analyse your current term insurance policy in detail. Check the sum assured, policy duration, premium affordability, and whether the plan allows increases in coverage at key life stages. Many insurers offer options to enhance cover after

events such as childbirth or a home purchase, sometimes without additional medical tests.

IS IT SUFFICIENT?
Compare your existing coverage with your revised financial protection needs. If your current policy does not fully cover outstanding liabilities, replace your income for your family, or provide for long-term goals like children's education, in case of a shortfall in financial protection.

ENHANCE YOUR COVERAGE
To bridge this gap, you can either increase the sum assured within your existing policy through a top-up or life stage benefit (if allowed) or buy an additional term insurance policy linked to specific needs such as your home loan. This allows you to maintain higher coverage during years of greater responsibility with flexibility to adjust later.

WHY PERIODIC REVIEW MATTERS
Having adequate life insurance cover is more important than simply owning a policy. Reviewing your term insurance periodically ensures it keeps pace with changing responsibilities and continues to provide strong financial security for your family.
The writer is Head, Product Development and Strategy, Bajaj Life Insurance

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.6	6.4	6.4	Mar 25
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5.25	Jan 31
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.3	6.25	Mar 02
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	5	6.2	6.25	6	Dec 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.6	6.15	6.05	Mar 03
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	Dec 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	Feb 24
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	6.3	6.45	6.1	6	Dec 11
Union Bank	6.1	6.6	6.25	6	Feb 11
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	Mar 27
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7	7.25	7.25	Mar 25
CSB Bank	6.75	7	6.5	5.75	Sep 10
City Union Bank	6.25	7	6.5	6.25	Mar 11
DCB Bank	6.5	7.15	7.15	7.15	Mar 19
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	6.95	6.25	7	Mar 26
Federal Bank	6	6.7	6.75	6.4	Mar 12
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Mar 27
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.4	7	7	Mar 19
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	6.9	6.65	Sep 25
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	6.65	6.15	6.15	Aug 01
Kotak Bank	6	6.7	6.7	6.4	Feb 11
Karur Vysya Bank	6.65	6.55	6.55	6.55	Sep 26
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.8	6.2	6.2	Mar 21
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.4	7.1	6.6	6.6	Jan 08
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	7	Mar 05
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	6.9	7.4	7	Mar 02
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	8	7.25	6	Mar 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	8	7.5	7.77	Mar 23
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	7.25	7.9	06-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	7.5	7.5	7.25	Dec 01
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.45	7.25	7.2	05-Aug

*Data as on respective banks' website on 27 Mar 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; Interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com

ALERTS.
Three new funds from Tata AIA Life

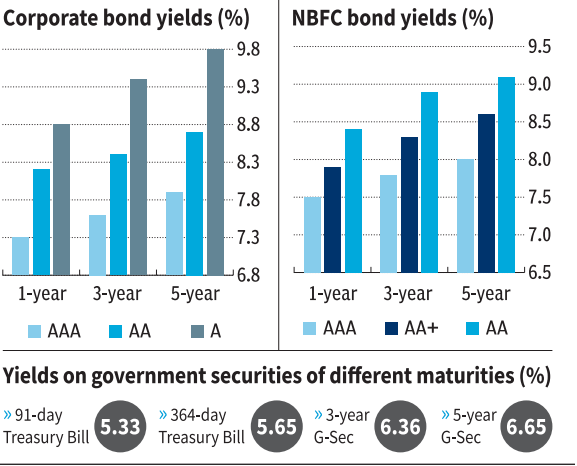
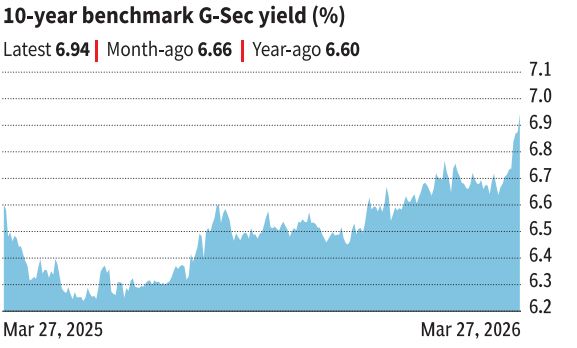
Tata AIA Life Insurance has launched three new funds – the Large Mid Cap Innovation Fund, Large Mid Cap Innovation Pension Fund, and Global AI & Technology Leaders Fund. These offerings are designed to help investors tap into India's innovation-led growth as well as global advancements in AI and technology, while continuing to benefit from life insurance protection through ULIPs.

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
		Oct 1 - Dec 31, 2025	Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit	1 year	4.0	4.0	Annually
	2 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	3 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	4 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5*	7.5*	Annually
Sukanya Samridhii Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on Dec 31, 2025
#Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

Bond yields



Health insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male, non-smoker, sum insured of ₹10 lakh living in a metro city

Insurer	Plan name	Key features	Premium (₹)
ICICI Lombard	Elevate	OPD rider with no sub-limits. Single pvt AC Room. ₹2 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,792
Care	Care Supreme	Guaranteed 7x increase over 5 years with rider. No Room Rent Limit. ₹15 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover.	10,838
Niva Bupa Health	Health ReAssure	Unlimited claims up to the cover amount. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	12,033
Star Health	Super Star	Fully loaded plan with one-time unlimited claim. Unlimited bonus. Lock the age till 50. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB.	8,173
Aditya Birla Health	Activ One Max	100% issuance offer guarantee. No Room Rent Limit. ₹10 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover	8,828
Tata AIG	Medicare Select	Special discount for young families and salaried customers. Single pvt AC Room. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,474
Reliance General	My HealthCare	Additional 30% discount on premium & fully customisable plan. Single pvt AC Room. ₹3.33 lakh NCB. Restoration of cover once a year.	7,326

Date: March 27, 2026. Source: www.policybazaar.com. NCB: No Claim Bonus

Term insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male/female, non smoker, living in a metro city, Sum assured ₹1 crore with coverage up to 70 yrs

Insurance company	Plan name	Max coverage up to (years)	Max policy term	Annual premium		Claim settlement ratio (%)
				Male	Female	
Aditya Birla Capital	Super Term Plan	85	55	11,167	9,203	98.4
Bajaj Life	eTouch II	85	55	10,714	8,832	99.3
Canara HSBC Life	Young Term Plan - Life Secure	99	69	11,345	9,477	99.2
HDFC Life	Click 2 Protect Super	85	55	12,390	10,531	99.7
ICICI Prudential	iProtect Smart	99	69	14,462	9,645	99.3
Axis Max Life	Smart Term Plan Plus	85	55	11,217	9,527	99.7
SBI Life	Smart Shield Plus	79	49	13,206	11,109	99.4
TATA AIA Life	Sampoorna Raksha Promise	100	70	11,111	9,429	99.4
Bandhan Life	iTerm Prime	70	40	11,466	9,963	99.7

Claim settlement ratio as per data provided by insurer
Source: www.policybazaar.com, Date: March 27, 2026



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS

*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	56.9	17104	1.7	0.5	-3.9	12.7	10.4	13.3	0.34
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	102.0	77452	1.4	0.9	-1.2	15.4	13.9	14.1	0.50
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	83.4	51404	1.5	0.7	-0.6	16.5	15.8	14.2	0.54
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1044.6	40085	1.6	1.0	-3.2	13.1	13.0	13.0	0.43
*****	JM Large Cap	140.2	443	2.4	0.9	-2.4	13.2	11.3	10.6	0.35
*****	Kotak Large Cap	526.5	10925	1.7	0.6	-1.1	13.1	11.2	12.3	0.36
*****	SBI Large Cap	85.7	55246	1.5	0.8	-1.3	12.2	10.9	11.9	0.36
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	476.8	30094	1.6	1.0	-2.7	12.9	11.4	11.9	0.37
***	Bandhan Large Cap	71.0	2024	2.0	0.9	-0.6	15.0	11.6	12.3	0.36
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	203.1	2639	2.0	0.8	-2.3	13.8	11.7	12.4	0.38
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	77.4	1477	2.1	0.6	-2.1	12.7	11.3	12.5	0.37
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	945.1	7580	1.9	1.1	-1.0	12.8	9.9	10.7	0.31
***	Invesco India Largecap	62.7	1702	2.0	0.7	-0.8	15.1	12.4	12.2	0.37
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	102.1	40184	1.5	0.6	-2.8	10.8	9.6	12.7	0.30
***	Tata Large Cap	462.4	2784	2.0	1.0	-2.4	12.8	11.3	11.5	0.37
***	UTI Large Cap	246.1	12658	1.8	0.9	-4.3	10.6	9.1	11.2	0.27
***	DSP Large Cap	433.0	7270	1.8	0.9	-3.5	15.6	11.7	11.5	0.41
**	HSBC Large Cap	442.2	1894	2.1	1.3	0.0	13.3	10.5	12.1	0.31
**	LIC MF Large Cap	49.5	1422	2.2	1.1	-5.0	9.4	8.2	10.2	0.23
**	Union Largecap	21.4	453	2.5	1.7	-3.7	11.0	9.6	-	0.29
**	Axis Large Cap	55.1	32437	1.6	0.7	-4.1	10.6	7.5	11.7	0.20
*	Groww Largecap	39.6	132	2.5	1.3	0.1	12.2	10.1	11.1	0.29
*	PGIM India Large Cap	305.3	568	2.4	0.8	-4.3	8.8	7.9	9.7	0.22
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.0	737	2.3	0.8	-3.5	12.3	10.3	-	0.32
-	Taurus Large Cap	147.0	51	2.6	2.3	0.0	15.2	11.2	10.1	0.32

EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	125.4	14780	1.7	0.5	2.7	21.6	17.6	15.5	0.56
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	307.1	28580	1.6	0.9	-1.3	17.7	16.3	14.2	0.52
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	94.2	28506	1.6	0.8	1.3	19.0	18.3	15.5	0.67
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	301.2	15559	1.7	0.6	1.0	18.0	13.9	-	0.41
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	101.2	3070	2.0	0.8	-7.0	14.6	14.8	14.9	0.42
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	591.9	38766	1.6	0.7	3.3	16.2	15.7	14.8	0.56
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	168.3	5724	1.8	0.9	2.1	20.2	16.6	13.9	0.56
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	83.4	456	2.3	1.1	3.3	16.0	14.2	12.6	0.42
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	224.4	24731	1.6	0.6	-4.8	13.9	11.9	14.8	0.36
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	572.0	17653	1.7	0.6	-1.5	18.4	14.6	14.8	0.48
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	80.8	4485	1.8	0.4	1.6	17.1	13.8	14.2	0.43
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	89.1	9392	1.8	0.6	2.3	21.8	15.8	15.2	0.44
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	320.2	30712	1.6	0.6	2.7	17.1	14.9	15.2	0.48
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	139.3	42943	1.5	0.6	2.3	15.4	12.5	16.7	0.38
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1343.0	6963	1.9	1.1	-1.0	18.7	15.3	12.6	0.49
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	171.9	3464	2.0	1.3	-0.9	14.7	12.0	11.2	0.36
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	34.7	3045	1.9	0.6	-4.1	16.0	12.7	14.2	0.40
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	78.2	6868	1.8	0.7	-0.9	15.0	12.6	13.7	0.37
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	444.3	8143	1.8	0.7	-9.9	9.3	10.0	12.0	0.33
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	830.3	5761	1.9	1.1	0.1	14.0	9.3	11.5	0.23
*	Navi Large & Midcap	31.8	307	2.3	0.5	-3.2	11.0	11.1	12.5	0.34
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	25.1	4706	1.9	0.8	5.2	18.8	14.3	-	0.36

EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS

*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1859.7	100455	1.3	0.7	0.6	19.1	18.7	16.2	0.67
*****	JM Flexicap	85.2	5159	1.8	0.7	-6.7	17.4	15.2	15.9	0.47
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	79.0	134253	1.3	0.6	-0.7	17.3	16.0	16.9	0.63
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	35.5	3203	1.9	0.4	0.8	16.8	13.9	14.4	0.43
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1480.8	19598	1.7	0.9	-3.0	16.0	14.2	13.2	0.45
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	32.7	6004	1.8	0.5	-2.1	10.8	10.4	13.3	0.30
*****	Union Flexi Cap	46.2	2349	2.0	0.9	-1.9	13.5	11.8	12.7	0.36
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1696.1	25207	1.7	0.9	2.6	16.7	12.9	13.9	0.40
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	190.9	7427	1.9	1.1	-0.1	14.4	11.5	10.9	0.36
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	308.3	13390	1.7	0.6	-1.0	13.3	11.2	13.7	0.36
***	DSP Flexi Cap	92.5	12165	1.7	0.7	-4.0	15.1	11.3	13.8	0.34
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	197.4	5279	1.9	1.2	-0.3	16.5	13.3	12.5	0.37
***	Kotak Flexicap	78.3	56853	1.4	0.6	1.1	14.7	12.1	13.5	0.38
***	SBI Flexicap	99.2	23297	1.7	0.8	-2.1	11.0	9.9	11.9	0.32
***	Tata Flexi Cap	22.1	3699	1.9	0.6	-0.9	14.7	10.8	-	0.35
**	Axis Flexi Cap	24.1	12871	1.7	0.7	-1.8	13.5	9.4	-	0.25
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	52.3	12890	1.7	0.8	-8.8	19.5	10.9	12.2	0.29
**	Navi Flexi Cap	21.4	261	2.2	0.6	2.0	11.8	11.0	-	0.34
**	UTI Flexi Cap	274.7	22886	1.7	1.1	-9.1	8.3	5.6	11.1	0.12
*	LIC MF Flexi Cap	88.8	1000	2.3	1.6	1.4	12.7	9.5	9.5	0.27
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	18.1	131	2.4	0.5	-5.7	8.9	8.0	-	0.20
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	200.3	346	2.7	2.6	-5.1	13.2	10.1	9.3	0.30
-	Quant Flexi Cap	89.8	6354	1.8	0.7	-1.9	16.1	17.9	18.4	0.50

EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS

-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	258.7	3096	2.0	0.9	-2.0	16.6	14.9	13.7	0.41
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	732.0	16315	1.7	0.9	-0.4	18.1	15.6	14.2	0.52
-	Invesco India Multicap	110.4	4001	1.8	0.8	-6.4	15.6	17.9	15.6	0.49
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	32.9	6174	1.8	0.5	2.9	18.9	16.7	-	0.47
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	272.0	50820	1.5	0.7	0.7	19.6	19.6	15.2	0.62
-	Quant Multi Cap	547.8	7274	1.8	0.7	-7.0	11.0	13.1	16.2	0.34
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	342.0	2827	2.0	0.9	-2.1	15.3	14.0	14.4	0.42

EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS

*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	94.2	14355	1.7	0.5	4.6	23.9	19.5	18.0	0.57
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	184.5	94257	1.4	0.8	6.0	23.8	20.7	17.8	0.67
*****	Quant Mid Cap	191.2	7341	1.8	0.8	-6.4	15.6	17.9	15.6	0.49
*****	Invesco India Midcap	161.0	10772	1.7	0.5	5.4	24.5	18.9	17.6	0.52
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	31.6	4440	1.9	0.6	3.9	23.2	18.9	-	0.55
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	83.0	33689	1.6	0.8	-11.0	19.7	21.1	15.9	0.54
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	3917.2	43983	1.5	0.7	5.7	24.5	20.5	18.3	0.62
***	Axis Midcap	104.8	31977	1.6	0.6	3.2	18.6	14.3	16.5	0.42
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	97.5	2341	2.0	0.5	5.2	20.0	16.4	15.3	0.49
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	294.8	7280	1.9	1.0	13.5	23.9	18.6	16.2	0.57
***	Kotak Midcap	125.0	61694	1.4	0.4	5.5	19.7	17.3	17.5	0.52
***	PGIM India Midcap	57.3	10877	1.7	0.5	-2.1	11.9	13.3	15.1	0.40
***	SBI Midcap	211.8	23154	1.7	0.9	-3.6	15.0	14.9	13.9	0.48
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1297.9	13235	1.7	0.9	4.6	22.9	18.1	14.8	0.52
***	Tata Mid Cap	406.7	5505	1.8	0.6	3.9	20.1	16.2	15.8	0.50
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	712.9	6130	1.9	1.0	0.0	18.8	15.5	13.3	0.46
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2454.0	12328	1.8	1.0	-2.5	19.4	14.8	14.3	0.42
**	Taurus Mid Cap	105.6	123	2.5	1.9	-2.5	14.5	12.1	14.4	0.33
**	UTI Mid Cap	272.4	11734	1.8	0.9	1.1	16.1	13.1	13.7	0.39
**	DSP Midcap	136.1	19641	1.7	0.7	3.8	19.0	12.6	14.6	0.37
**	HSBC Midcap	373.1	12448	1.7	0.7	10.0	23.4	16.9	16.3	0.44
*	LIC MF Midcap	25.7	337	2.5	1.4	-3.5	18.7	12.8	-	0.35

EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS

*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	150.1	67642	1.4	0.7	0.1	19.1	21.0	19.9	0.55
*****	Quant Small Cap	224.3	27654	1.6	0.8	-2.9	18.5	22.4	17.4	0.54
*****	AXIS Small Cap	94.9	26008	1.6	0.6	-0.7	16.4	17.2	17.5	0.52

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	

★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	41.4	1904	2.0	0.5	-1.1	18.5	18.1	-	0.44
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	37.6	9716	1.7	0.4	2.9	22.4	20.0	-	0.52
★★★★	DSP Small Cap	178.9	16886	1.7	0.8	4.9	18.8	18.1	16.0	0.48
★★★★	HDFC Small Cap	121.4	37424	1.6	0.7	-0.2	15.9	18.6	17.1	0.51
★★★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	76.1	8355	1.8	0.8	-1.3	13.8	16.1	15.1	0.53
★★★★	Kotak Small Cap	222.9	16871	1.7	0.6	-5.5	13.0	13.7	15.8	0.38
★★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	230.8	3306	1.9	0.8	2.9	17.4	17.2	13.8	0.44
★★★★	Tata Small Cap	31.1	10715	1.7	0.4	-14.9	10.7	15.8	-	0.43
★★★★	Union Small Cap	46.3	1787	2.1	1.0	7.8	19.2	17.5	15.2	0.43
★★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	148.8	12934	1.8	0.9	-2.0	16.5	17.6	14.7	0.45
★★	HSBC Small Cap	69.7	15375	1.7	0.7	-4.2	15.1	18.7	17.4	0.45
★★	SBI Small Cap	149.9	34932	1.6	0.8	-4.3	12.0	13.9	17.0	0.40
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	77.8	4882	1.9	0.9	2.8	17.3	13.2	12.5	0.33
★	LIC MF Small Cap	26.4	606	2.4	1.0	-5.2	15.6	16.9	-	0.42
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	34.2	12769	1.7	0.6	-0.8	14.2	17.7	-	0.49
-	Edelweiss Small Cap	39.1	5481	1.8	0.5	0.8	17.9	17.6	-	0.50

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %ann	3 Month %ann	6 Month %ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2094.5	1283	0.3	0.2	5.3	5.7	5.7	6.0	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	438.8	51838	0.4	0.2	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
- Axis Liquid	3033.1	43636	0.2	0.1	5.4	5.9	5.9	6.2	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3287.5	17384	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.7	5.8	6.1	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3138.7	1915	0.1	0.1	5.5	5.9	5.9	6.2	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3130.7	12362	0.3	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.0	-
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3278.1	7457	0.2	0.1	5.5	5.8	5.9	6.2	-
- DSP Liquidity	3888.8	21058	0.2	0.1	5.4	5.9	5.9	6.2	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3483.8	10631	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.9	6.1	-
- Groww Liquid	2633.9	164	0.2	0.1	5.4	5.8	5.9	6.2	-
- HDFC Liquid	5342.5	67850	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
- HSBC Liquid	2714.5	17735	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.7	5.8	6.2	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	403.1	53738	0.3	0.2	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3742.9	15423	0.2	0.2	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
- ITI Liquid	1416.9	56	0.3	0.1	4.8	5.4	5.6	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	74.3	2577	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.7	5.8	6.0	-
- Kotak Liquid	5502.4	42746	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.7	5.8	6.2	-
- LIC MF Liquid	4922.4	14187	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.0	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1772.8	1145	0.3	0.2	5.4	5.8	5.9	6.1	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2855.2	12395	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.7	5.8	6.2	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.4	1114	0.4	0.2	5.3	5.5	5.6	5.8	-
- Navi Liquid	29.5	84	0.2	0.2	5.2	5.4	5.5	5.8	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6646.1	32736	0.3	0.2	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.1	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1510.0	5098	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.8	5.8	6.0	-
- PGIM India Liquid	354.5	677	0.2	0.1	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.2	-
- Quant Liquid	43.0	1261	0.5	0.2	5.3	5.6	5.6	5.9	-
- Quantum Liquid	36.4	567	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.5	5.5	5.7	-
- SBI Liquid	4254.5	66119	0.3	0.2	5.2	5.7	5.8	6.1	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2399.7	6221	0.4	0.1	5.1	5.6	5.7	6.1	-
- Tata Liquid	4290.6	33551	0.3	0.2	5.5	5.9	5.9	6.1	-
- Union Liquid	2620.9	7923	0.2	0.1	5.4	5.8	5.9	6.2	-
- UTI Liquid	4468.9	27263	0.2	0.1	5.4	5.8	5.9	6.1	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1463.7	600	0.3	0.2	5.4	5.7	5.7	6.1	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.7	26792	1.0	0.3	5.5	6.0	6.0	6.3	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.5	9212	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.3	6.1	6.2	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	33.8	8650	1.1	0.4	5.6	6.0	5.8	6.0	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.4	49	0.9	0.4	6.6	6.2	5.9	5.9	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.7	1362	1.1	0.3	5.3	5.8	5.8	6.1	0.00
- DSP Arbitrage	15.6	6923	1.0	0.4	5.7	6.1	6.0	6.1	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.2	15452	1.1	0.4	5.8	6.1	6.0	6.2	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.0	24768	0.9	0.4	6.0	6.3	6.1	6.3	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	19.8	2433	0.9	0.3	7.2	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
- ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	35.8	32989	0.9	0.4	5.0	6.4	6.2	6.3	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	33.3	28527	1.1	0.4	5.6	6.3	6.2	6.3	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.6	49	0.9	0.2	8.2	7.5	6.7	6.6	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.0	355	1.1	0.4	6.5	6.2	6.0	5.9	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	39.1	71265	1.0	0.4	6.3	6.4	6.2	6.3	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.4	277	1.0	0.3	7.0	6.6	6.0	6.1	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.8	98	1.1	0.4	5.6	5.7	5.6	5.5	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.6	3834	0.9	0.2	6.3	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.7	16515	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.2	6.1	6.2	1.70
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.1	105	1.0	0.4	6.8	6.4	6.0	5.9	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.3	44393	0.9	0.4	6.5	6.4	6.2	6.4	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.1	335	1.0	0.3	6.4	6.4	6.1	6.2	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.0	21327	1.1	0.3	6.1	6.2	6.1	6.3	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.6	276	1.0	0.4	6.7	6.3	6.0	6.0	-
- UTI Arbitrage	36.6	11070	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.3	6.2	6.4	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Savings	572.8	21467	0.6	0.3	6.8	7.3	7.3	6.3	9.89
***** Baroda BNPP Ultra Short Duration	1607.8	670	0.5	0.3	6.4	6.9	7.1	6.1	2.25
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4199.2	10672	1.1	0.4	6.3	6.8	6.8	6.7	28.54
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	15.9	3732	0.5	0.3	6.4	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	28.9	16816	0.8	0.4	6.5	7.0	7.0	6.1	10.98
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1364.6	1809	0.5	0.1	6.5	7.1	7.2	6.1	1.66
***** UTI Ultra Short Duration	4409.9	3946	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.6	6.7	6.2	10.88
***** Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.3	5824	1.2	0.4	6.0	6.5	6.6	5.6	8.95
***** DSP Ultra Short	3539.2	3714	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.5	10.16
***** HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.8	17171	0.7	0.4	6.3	6.9	7.0	5.9	4.22
***** HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1412.1	2874	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
***** Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2807.9	1292	0.8	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.9	5.7	11.55
***** Kotak Savings	44.7	16105	0.8	0.4	6.4	6.8	6.9	5.8	8.20
***** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1433.0	217	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.8	6.9	5.8	4.38
***** SBI Ultra Short Duration	6232.8	13685	0.6	0.4	6.4	6.9	7.0	5.9	8.23
***** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dura	1413.3	541	1.0	0.5	5.8	6.3	6.4	5.4	-
***** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3284.8	165	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.3	6.3	5.4	6.68
***** LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1372.8	230	1.2	0.2	5.9	6.4	6.3	5.4	2.32
***** PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.4	165	0.9	0.4	5.7	6.3	6.4	5.5	-
***** Tata Ultra Short Term	14.7	3793	1.2	0.3	6.1	6.5	6.6	5.5	12.54
***** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3946.8	563	1.0	0.4	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.3	-
***** Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.1	441	1.0	0.2	5.1	5.5	5.7	4.7	-
***** Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2778.8	1907	1.4	0.2	5.3	5.9	6.0	5.0	1.63

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Savings	568.3	31284	0.6	0.4	6.9	7.4	7.6	6.4	7.25
***** UTI Low Duration	3701.1	2990	0.4	0.3	6.7	7.2	7.3	7.2	5.72
***** Axis Treasury Advantage	3226.0	7831	0.7	0.3	6.6	7.2	7.2	6.1	7.92
***** DSP Low Duration	20.6	5593	0.6	0.3	6.2	6.8	6.9	5.9	-
***** HDFC Low Duration	60.1	25582	1.1	0.5	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.0	11.02
***** HSBC Low Duration	29.9	1009	0.9	0.4	7.7	7.6	7.5	6.1	12.61
***** Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	681.7	15209	1.2	0.4	6.1	6.6	6.7	5.8	10.10
***** Bandhan Low Duration	40.1	5926	0.7	0.3	6.3	6.9	6.9	5.8	-
***** Canara Robeco Savings	43.9	1350	0.5	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	5.8	-
***** Invesco India Low Duration	3937.6	2065	0.7	0.3	6.3	6.9	7.0	5.9	8.36
***** JM Low Duration	38.5	222	0.9	0.4	6.2	6.8	6.8	5.7	5.62
***** Nippon Ind Low Duration	3895.7	10969	1.0	0.4	6.3	6.9	6.9	5.9	8.89
***** SBI Low Duration	3628.6	16391	1.0	0.4	6.1	6.7	6.8	5.7	1.71
***** Tata Treasury Advantage	4090.6	3491	0.6	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.0	5.9	3.00
***** Kotak Low Duration	3475.9	16393	1.2	0.4	6.2	6.8	6.8	5.8	10.70
***** Mahi Manu Low Duration	1698.1	573	1.1	0.3	6.1	6.6	6.7	5.6	15.12
***** Mirae Asset Low Duration	2347.3	2720	0.9	0.2	6.1	6.8	6.8	5.7	3.32
***** Sundaram Low Duration	3585.5	470	1.2	0.4	5.8	6.6	6.6	5.6	2.77
***** Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.6	301	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.5	6.7	5.6	5.02
***** LIC MF Low Duration	41.1	2018	1.2	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.6	5.6	2.58

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

***** Nippon Ind Money Market	4333.5	21876	0.4	0.2	6.7	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
***** UTI Money Market	3221.3	20320	0.2	0.1	6.7	7.2	7.4	6.3	-
***** Aditya Birla SL Money Manager	386.3	30778	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
***** Axis Money Market	1494.7	23790	0.3	0.2	6.7	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
***** ICICI Pru Money Market	396.3	35305	0.4	0.2	6.7	7.2	7.3	6.2	-
***** Kotak Money Market	4690.1	33661	0.4	0.2	6.7	7.2	7.3	6.2	-
***** Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1438.6	4965	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.0	7.0	5.8	-
***** Franklin Ind Money Market	52.4	4352	0.3	0.1	6.7	7.2	7.3	6.1	-
***** HDFC Money Market	5968.5	33094	0.5	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.3	6.2	-
***** PGIM India Money Market	1382.3	226	0.5	0.2	6.4	6.8	6.9	5.8	-
***** Sundaram Money Market	15.7	2334	0.3	0.2	6.6	7.1	7.1	6.0	-
***** Tata Money Market	4931.1	36819	0.4	0.2	6.7	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
***** DSP Savings	54.9	8549	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
***** HSBC Money Market	27.5	5379	0.3	0.2	6.5	7.0	7.1	5.8	-
***** Invesco India Money Market	3176.4	6596	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.1	5.9	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

★★ SBI Savings	43.2	35418	0.7	0.3	6.3	6.8	6.9	5.8	-
★ Bandhan Money Market	42.1	14805	0.4	0.1	6.6	7.0	7.0	5.7	-
★ Edelweiss Money Market	29.6	3027	0.7	0.1	6.1	6.6	6.6	5.4	-

DEBT - SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Short Term	62.4	22852	1.1	0.5	6.3	7.2	7.4	6.4	10.20
***** UTI Short Duration	32.7	3090	0.8	0.4	5.7	6.7	7.0	6.9	9.73
***** Aditya Birla SL Short Term	49.2	9386	1.0	0.4	5.9	7.0	7.1	6.2	9.99
***** Axis Short Duration	32.0	11860	0.9	0.4	6.2	7.2	7.2	6.1	5.66
***** HDFC Short Term Debt	33.2	17271	0.7	0.4	6.1	7.2	7.4	6.2	8.21
***** Nippon Ind Short Duration	54.6	8367	0.9	0.4	6.1	7.2	7.2	6.1	7.92
*** Bandhan Short Duration	59.1	10283	0.8	0.3	6.0	7.1	7.1	5.8	-
*** Baroda BNP Paribas Short Duration	30.1	297	1.1	0.4	5.7	6.8	6.9	5.7	1.70
*** HSBC Short Duration	27.3	4308	0.7	0.3	5.9	7.0	6.9	5.6	-
*** Kotak Bond Short Term	53.7	17568	1.1	0.4	5.5	6.7	6.9	5.7	-
*** Mirae Asset Short Duration	16.2	580	1.1	0.2	5.4	6.7	6.7	5.5	0.86
*** SBI Short Term Debt	32.3	17213	0.9	0.4	5.9	7.0	7.0	5.8	6.00
*** Sundaram Short Duration	45.8	201	0.7	0.3	5.8	7.0	7.0	5.9	2.50
** Canara Robeco Short Duration	26.2	366	1.0	0.4	5.4	6.4	6.5	5.3	-
** DSP Short Term	47.9	3743	0.9	0.4	5.4	6.6	6.7	5.5	-
** Invesco India Short Duration	3677.7	1064	1.1	0.4	5.7	6.7	6.8	5.5	5.46
** Tata Short Term Bond	49.2	3745	1.2	0.3	4.9	6.3	6.4	5.4	-
** Groww Short Duration	2147.0	94	1.1	0.4	5.7	6.5	6.1	4.9	-
** LIC MF Short Duration	15.0	194	1.2	0.4	5.2	6.4	6.5	5.1	5.52
- Bank of India Short Term Income	27.6	279	1.0	0.5	5.4	7.3	7.0	10.1	2.89
- Mahi Manu Short Duration	13.2	89	1.3	0.4	5.6	6.7	6.7	5.5	15.65

PM Modi inaugurates phase 1 of Noida International Airport

INFRA PUSH. The airport will boost connectivity and opportunities for farmers, MSMEs and youth: PM

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday inaugurated Phase-1 of the Noida International Airport at Jewar in Uttar Pradesh, calling it a major catalyst for connectivity, logistics and economic expansion across North India.

Accordingly, PM Modi said the airport marks a “new chapter” in development and reiterated that it will act as a key engine of growth for western Uttar Pradesh.

NEW HUB

He highlighted that Uttar Pradesh has now emerged among the States with the highest number of international airports.

Besides, the Prime Minister said the airport will benefit a wide regional belt including Agra, Mathura, Aligarh, Ghaziabad, Meerut, Etawah, Bulandshahr and Faridabad, while generating new opportunities



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Union Civil Aviation Minister K Ram Mohan Naidu, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, Deputy CM Keshav Prasad Maurya, Governor Anandiben Patel and others during the inauguration

for farmers, micro, small and medium enterprises, and youth.

Furthermore, PM Modi said the project is part of a broader infrastructure push in western Uttar Pradesh, citing the semiconductor factory in Noida, expansion of the Meerut Metro, and the Delhi-Meerut Namo Bharat rail as parallel initiatives.

He noted that the airport is integ-

rated with major expressways and rail networks, improving multimodal connectivity across the region.

Additionally, PM Modi thanked farmers who contributed land for the airport (NIA) project and emphasised the role of infrastructure in strengthening food processing and global market access.

Prime Minister also noted the

role of farmers in supporting the economy, particularly through ethanol production from sugarcane, stating that it has reduced crude oil import dependence and generated significant foreign exchange savings.

At the same event, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath said the inauguration reflects a new phase of development under the “double-engine government.”

Furthermore, the UP CM said Noida International Airport is being developed as a major logistics and investment hub, integrated with expressways and rail networks, and is expected to generate employment for lakhs of youth.

He added that the region will attract industries such as semiconductors, electronics manufacturing, apparel, medical devices and data centres, supported by a multimodal cargo ecosystem and future expansion plans including additional runways.

Farmers urge WTO to permanently renew the TRIPS NVC moratorium

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

As negotiations intensify at the 14th World Trade Organization (WTO) Ministerial Conference at Yaoundé, Cameroon, the quid-pro-quo diplomacy between digital trade and intellectual property is in focus. While the US continues to push for a permanent moratorium on e-commerce duties, India remains a staunch opponent to making the moratorium permanent, bolstered by a fresh plea from its domestic agricultural sector on a related relaxation in IP rules.

The Rashtriya Kisan Mahasangh (RKM), a prominent Indian farmers’ body including 136 organisations, issued a formal letter to all WTO members urging the permanent renewal of the TRIPS Non-Violation Complaint (NVC) moratorium.

The group warned that allowing the moratorium to



lapse would jeopardise the availability of affordable agrochemicals and veterinary medicines, essential for the survival of small-scale farmers.

“Permanent renewal of the TRIPS NVC moratorium at the MC 14, as it remains critical for safeguarding access to affordable agricultural inputs (including agrochemicals) and veterinary medicines. The continuation of this moratorium is not only vital for protecting policy space in the public interest, but also for ensuring the viability of domestic generic production systems, including

State-owned agrochemical manufacturers such as Hindustan Insecticides Ltd and similar enterprises,” the letter by RKM noted.

SUPPORT FARMERS

For developing nations such as India, the TRIPS NVC moratorium protects the policy space needed to support domestic generic production.

In its submission, the RKM pointed out that an average of 10,000 Indian farmers commit suicide annually due to spiralling input costs and stagnant crop prices.

The farmers argued that making the TRIPS NVC moratorium permanent is not just a trade technicality, but a “must” for national food security.

“The permanent renewal of the TRIPS NVC moratorium is a must, recognising its direct implications for farmer livelihoods, public health, and national food security,” the letter said.

India, Brazil, South Africa hold firm against permanent e-comm moratorium at WTO MC14

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Members remain sharply divided at the World Trade Organisation’s 14th Ministerial Conference (MC14) over the future of the moratorium on e-commerce duties. The US has dug in its heels, pushing for a permanent ban on customs duties for electronic transmissions, while a bloc of developing nations, including India, Brazil, and South Africa, is exploring a range of alternatives — from scrapping the moratorium altogether to extending it by two years or slightly beyond — leaving negotiations in a delicate impasse, sources said.

“The US representative has

been insisting at the break-out meetings at the ongoing MC14 (in Yaoundé, Cameroon) that it will not accept anything other than a permanent moratorium on e-commerce duties. But this is impossible for India and some other developing countries to accept as it would permanently close a potentially thriving revenue source,” a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

INDIA FLAGS REVENUE LOSS

The e-commerce moratorium is a 28-year-old “temporary” agreement among WTO members (being renewed every two years so far) not to impose customs duties on electronic transmissions.

India has been questioning the

A 28-year-old “temporary” WTO moratorium has become a flashpoint, with the US pushing permanence and developing nations warning of lost revenue and policy space



clear definition of “electronic transmissions”, which it says could widen the scope to dangerous levels in the years to come.

“It is understood that Brazil is ready to accept an extension of the moratorium by two years but not beyond. The same is being said about South Africa. India, so

far, has been opposing its extension. It could agree to a two-year extension if other things are favourable but not beyond it,” the source said. Intense meetings are going on between various countries on the matter to arrive at a decision in time for the conclusion of the MC14 on March 29, the source added.

Another source pointed out that there were discussions on a middle ground as well, such as an extension of the moratorium for four years or six years.

In his opening statement at the WTO MC14 on Thursday, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal highlighted the need to reconsider the moratorium extension. “In the absence of a com-

mon understanding among members on the scope of the moratorium on customs duties on electronic transmissions and given its potentially significant implications, the continued extension of this moratorium warrants careful reconsideration,” Goyal said.

US’ DEMAND

In stark contrast, US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer made it clear that Washington wanted to make permanent duty-free access for its software and streaming giants (such as Microsoft, Netflix, Google, Spotify etc.) to ensure these companies aren’t suddenly hit with varying tariffs in WTO member countries.

IndiGo flight makes emergency landing in Delhi

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

A Delhi-bound IndiGo flight from Visakhapatnam, carrying 160 passengers, made an emergency landing at Delhi’s Indira Gandhi International Airport on Saturday due to engine failure.

“Full emergency was declared at Indira Gandhi International Airport at 10.39 for IndiGo Visakhapatnam-Delhi flight 6E 579 due to one engine failure,” a source said.

There were 160 passengers on board the Boeing 737 aircraft.

The flight landed at 10.59 am as per flight tracking website [flightradar24.com](#).

Security of entire country linked to outcome of Bengal polls, says Amit Shah

Our Bureau
Kolkata



Union Home Minister Amit Shah

Union Home Minister Amit Shah, who released the BJP’s “chargesheet” against the Trinamool Congress government ahead of the Assembly elections in West Bengal, on Saturday emphasised that the upcoming polls would be a choice between “fear and trust,” framing it as a battle not merely for the State, but for the country’s security because of illegal infiltrators.

The “chargesheet” highlighted 15 years of “oppression, corruption and bad governance” of the Mamata

Banerjee-led government in West Bengal.

The Minister said security of the entire country is inextricably linked to the outcome of the Bengal elections. “Only one route remains through

which infiltrators enter the country, compromising national security. Therefore, the election is vital for Bengal in many respects,” he said, alleging that the Trinamool Congress government openly facilitated infiltration.

Hitting back at Shah and the BJP, Banerjee asserted that the saffron party would lose power across the country in its attempt to destroy West Bengal.

“By attempting to destroy Bengal, the BJP will lose power across the country. There must be a *Lakshman rekha*, but the BJP is crossing all limits,” she said.

DMK fields 60 new faces for TN polls

Our Bureau
Chennai



DMK President MK Stalin announcing the party's candidates

The ruling Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) on Saturday unveiled its latest list of candidates for the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections, introducing 60 new faces in a significant refresh of its electoral lineup. The list includes 18 women.

Chief Minister MK Stalin has been renominated from Kodaikur, while Deputy Chief Minister Udhayanidhi Stalin will seek re-election from Chepauk-Triplicane. Three sitting Ministers — R Gandhi, Mano C Thangaraj and Kayalvizhi Selvaraj — have been dropped. However, dynastic continuity is evident, with Gandhi’s son fielded from Rani-

pet. Similarly, former Minister K Ponnudiy, who resigned following a controversy, has been left out, with his son contesting from Thirukoyilur.

Former Minister V Senthil Balaji, who stepped down from the Cabinet in April 2025 amid a money laundering case, will contest from Coim-

batore South, shifting from his traditional Karur base.

In Chennai, widely seen as a DMK bastion, the party will contest 15 of 16 seats, leaving Velachery to its ally, the Congress. Among the notable new entrants, Standing Committee Chairman N Chitrarasu will contest from Anna Nagar while first-time councillor AP Poornima has been fielded from Ambattur. Former AIADMK leader O Panneerselvam, who recently joined the DMK, has been fielded from Bodinayakkanur, a constituency he previously represented.

One of the high-profile contests is expected in Madurai Central, where IT Minister Palanivel Thiaga Rajan will face actor and filmmaker Sundar C, who is contesting on behalf of the Pudiya Neethi Katchi, which is part of the AIADMK-led alliance.

Kishan Reddy denies fuel shortage reports

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Union Minister for Coal and Mines G Kishan Reddy has dispelled fears of petrol, diesel and LPG shortages in Telangana, assuring the public that supplies are continuing smoothly across the country.

Referring to the widespread concerns over the last few days, the Minister blamed them on social media and asserted that there was no problem with the availability of oil and LPG.

Start-ups to include RSUs, SARs in executive pay

This comes at a time when start-ups are adjusting hiring amid cautious funding

Jyoti Banthia
Bangalore



The Centre’s plan to allow restricted stock units (RSUs) and stock appreciation rights (SARs) as part of executive compensation is expected to trigger a shift in how start-ups design pay packages for senior leadership, moving beyond the traditional reliance on employee stock option plans (ESOPs).

The amendments to the Companies Act, 2013 aim to formally recognise a wider set of stock-linked instruments, aligning compensation frameworks with global practices.

Industry experts said this could reshape hiring strategies, particularly at the leadership level where predictability and clarity of rewards are increasingly critical.

“The introduction of RSUs and SARs could significantly evolve how senior talent is compensated in start-ups. Until now, ESOPs have been the

EQUITY UNCERTAINTY. ESOP-heavy compensation structures are increasingly being viewed as uncertain, particularly when liquidity events such as IPOs or acquisitions are delayed

primary long-term incentive, but they often come with liquidity uncertainty and vesting risks,” said Saikiran Murali, Founder of Workline.

He added that RSUs and SARs offer more predictable value and clearer upside, making compensation easier to benchmark globally.

“For senior hires, especially those evaluating multiple opportunities, this adds a layer of confidence

and transparency. Over time, this could push start-ups to design more structured and balanced compensation packages that combine stability with long-term wealth creation,” Murali said.

HIRING STRATEGIES

The shift comes at a time when start-ups are recalibrating hiring strategies amid a more cautious funding environment.

Recruiters and founders

note that ESOP-heavy compensation structures are increasingly being viewed as uncertain, particularly when liquidity events such as IPOs or acquisitions are delayed.

“There is already a visible shift among start-ups, especially when it comes to leadership hiring. While ESOPs continue to play an important role, many founders are recognising that senior talent today looks for a mix of stability and upside,” Murali said.

According to him, start-ups are exploring more diversified compensation models that offer clearer value to candidates.

“The potential introduction of instruments like RSUs and SARs aligns well with this shift, as it gives companies more flexibility to design packages that are both competitive and aligned with long-term business performance,” he added.

KEY DIFFERENTIATOR

As competition for experienced talent intensifies, especially in technology and new-age sectors, the ability to offer globally comparable compensation structures could become a key differentiator for Indian start-ups.

AP urges Centre to recognise Amaravati as permanent capital

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Andhra Pradesh Assembly on Saturday unanimously passed a resolution seeking the Centre to grant statutory recognition to Amaravati as the permanent capital.

Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu moved the resolution in the Assembly, which was supported by all the members. The approved resolution has been forwarded to the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha, the Speaker of the Lok Sabha, the Union Home Minister and other authorities.

Speaking on the occasion, the Chief Minister said Amaravati was the sole and permanent capital of Andhra Pradesh and criticised the Opposition for “inconsistent and misleading” statements on the capital issue.

Naidu added that farmers had voluntarily contributed over 34,000 acres for the capital within just 58 days, in an “unprecedented act of sacrifice”.

Centre extends EV incentives under PM E-DRIVE scheme

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Electric two- and three-wheeler makers have welcomed the Centre’s decision to extend the PM E-DRIVE scheme till March 2028, even as the move draws a clear distinction between segments, limiting incentives for electric two-wheelers to July 2026 while continuing support for last-mile electric three-wheelers.

In a notification issued on March 27, the Ministry of Heavy Industries said the scheme, capped at ₹10,900 crore, will remain in force till March 31, 2028, or until the funds are exhausted, after which “no further claims will be entertained”. It added that incentives for registered electric two-wheelers will apply only to vehicles registered on the portal till July 31, 2026, with support continuing at ₹2,500 per kWh, capped at ₹5,000 per vehicle.

For electric three-wheelers, incentives for e-rickshaws and e-carts will continue for the full duration of the scheme, i.e., till March 31, 2028, unless funds are exhausted earlier.

TWO-WHEELERS

Industry executives said the change creates a compressed window for electric two-wheelers, setting up what many describe as a “registration cliff” ahead of the July deadline.

“The extension ensures continuity in policy support while allowing the industry to move towards a more self-sustaining model. For electric two-wheelers, this transition phase is critical as manufacturers recalibrate pricing, localisation and scale,” Hemant Kabra, Founder and Managing Director of BGauss said.

3W SEGMENT

For the three-wheeler segment, which continues to receive longer policy support, sentiment is more positive. Uday Narang, Founder and Chairman of Omega Seiki Mobility (OSM), said the decision reinforces the government’s focus on last-mile electrification.

With incentives for electric two-wheelers now applicable only till the end of July, OEMs contacted by *businessline* said they are in the process of evaluating whether to sustain or recalibrate these offers.

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